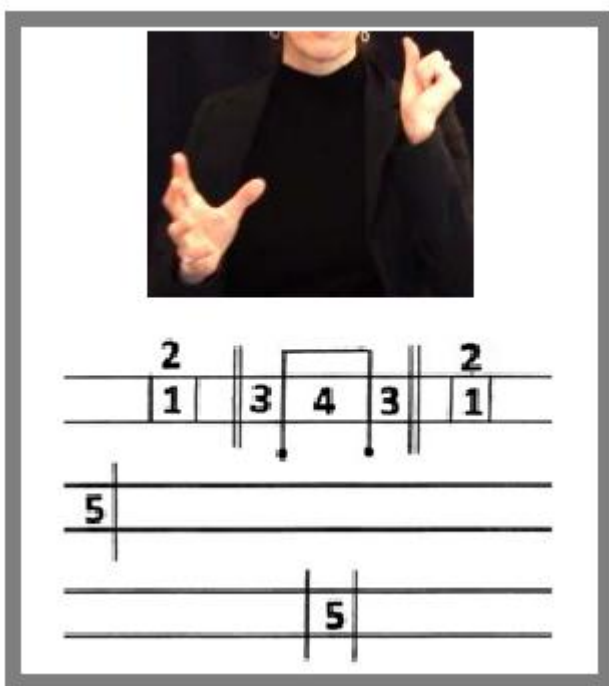


signotation

ASL WRITER'S GUIDE



How to Write Sign Language
Using the 5 Parameters

S. Hansen CI/CT/SC:L/Ed:K-12

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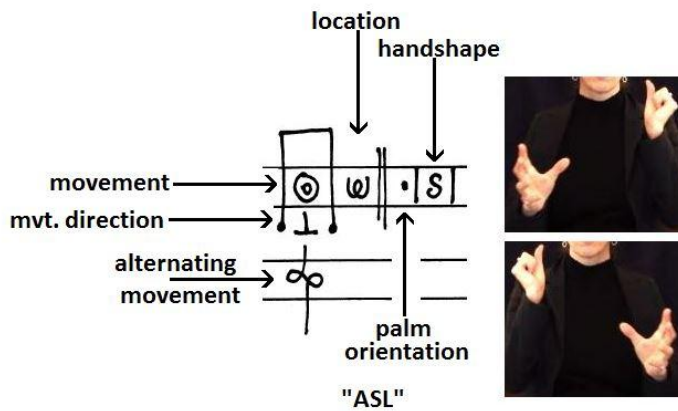
www.signotation.com

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ISBN-10: 0998718610

DEDICATION

To the Deaf Community for their daily inspiration and kindness to me, and to my family.



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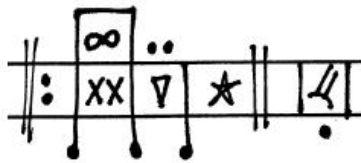
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ACKNOWLEDGMENTS

Thanks to my family, the Deaf community and online viewers for their feedback, critique and encouragement to pursue further development of a structural approach to sign languages in a written form.

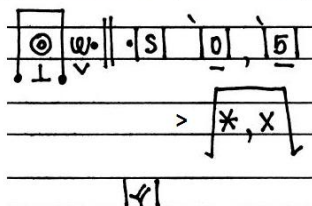
Mr. Stokoe's work in the 1960 has been an inspiration to me as a person who sought out patterns and meaning independently, based on interactional research.



"BUTTERFLY"



SIGNOTATION CORE PRINCIPLES



"SIGNOTATION"

STRUCTURAL APPROACH: Signotation is a structural method of recording the simultaneous and consecutive aspects of ASL/signed languages. The sign staff has three tiers to organize the 5 Parameters.

ARBITRARY SYMBOLS: The notations and symbols used in signotation are arbitrary and can be changed and updated by the Deaf community and adapted to any sign language globally.

SHARED TOOL FOR BILINGUAL ED: Signotation is a “work in progress” and is offered as a possible tool to improve bilingual education and literacy of Deaf/Hard of Hearing students and to increase awareness and appreciation of the structure and complexity of signed languages. Pragmatic uses include increased access to academic vocabulary, spelling, note-taking, and tri-lingual applications.

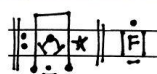
SIGN BASED: All notations and symbols created are tied to actual signs in use.

ARTICULATION VARIANTS: A single “root” sign can have many articulations which reflect changes in meaning along with stylistic choices. For example, the root sign: “finish” can be articulated several ways, in different locations in the signing space to convey different meaning and intent. Signotation attempts to allow variations in articulation to be notated accurately.

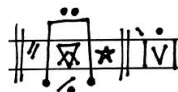
COLLABORATIVE EFFORT: Writing a language is a shared community task. Signotation is a proposed approach to this task by an educational interpreter in the hopes that further study, research, experimentation, application and revision will generate a useful educational tool.

ACCESS TO ACADEMIC VOCABULARY IN A "SIGN TO TEXT" DICTIONARY

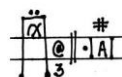
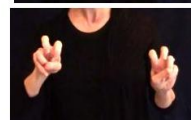
One of the most exciting prospects about this approach is the opportunity for students to utilize a "sign to text" dictionary reference. This simple tool has the potential to increase access to academic terms independently by the student. Students frequently recall the first letter(s) of a term and would be able to scan and locate the desired term as well as learn new vocabulary. Signs with more than one articulation could be grouped together and nuances in meaning discussed. Here are a few examples of common academic terms.



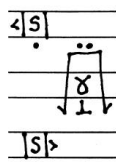
"IMPORTANT"
"CRITICAL"
"VITAL"



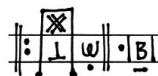
"ANALYZE"
"ASSESSMENT"



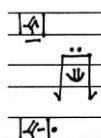
"SECRET"
"PRIVATE"
"PASS" (WORD)
"CLANDESTINE"
"CONFIDENTIAL"



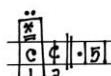
"MAKE"
"MANUFACTURE"
"PRODUCE"
"CREATE"



"BLOCK"
"PREVENT"
"BARRIER"
"OBSTACLE"
"THWART"



"ON THE FENCE"
"UNCERTAIN"
"INDECISIVE"
"AMBIVALENT"
"EQUIVOCATE"



"POLITE"
"COURTEOUS"
"MANNERS"



"LUCKY" / "LUCK"
"FORTUNATE"
"FORTUITOUS"

"ILLEGAL"
"PROHIBITED"
"UNLAWFUL"
"AGAINST THE RULES"

CONVENTIONS

Signotation incorporates standard conventions including:

- alphabetical characters
- numerical characters and symbols
- punctuation marks and symbols
- musical and mathematical symbols

in conjunction with simple sketching and created symbols as needed for grammatically accurate detail.

location

number of reps

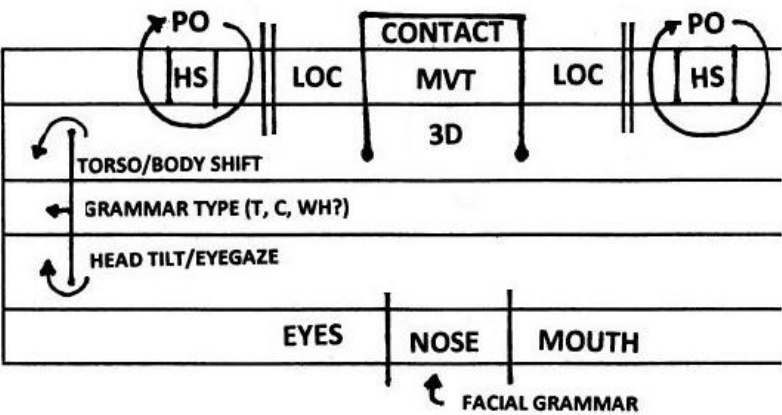
movement →

"SECRET"
"PRIVATE"
"PASS" (WORD)
"CLANDESTINE"
"CONFIDENTIAL"

on fingernail of HS

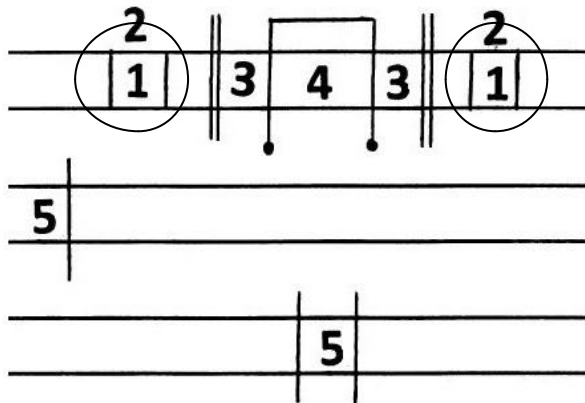
handshape and palm orientation

THE 5 PARAMETERS
OF SIGNOTATION ON THE SIGN STAFF



THE 5 PARAMETERS

1. Handshape (HS)
2. Palm Orientation (PO)
3. Location (LOC)
4. Movement (MVT)
5. Facial grammar (NMGM)



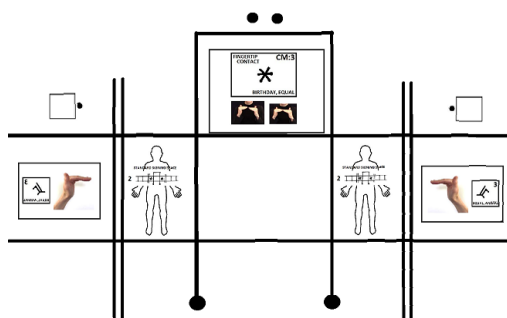
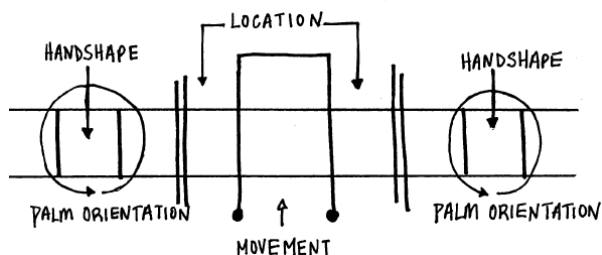
Source:

Linguistics of American Sign Language: An Introduction, Fifth Edition, 2011 by Valli, Lucas, Mulrooney and Villanueva (p. 21) "5 Parameter

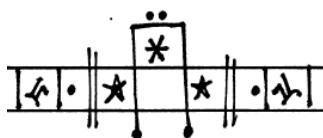
SIGNOTATION STAFF

Basic Signnotation

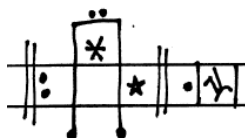
The most basic notation will require 4 parameters: **Handshape (HS)**, **Palm Orientation (PO)**, **Location (LOC)** and **Movement (MVT)**.



"EQUAL"



"EQUAL"

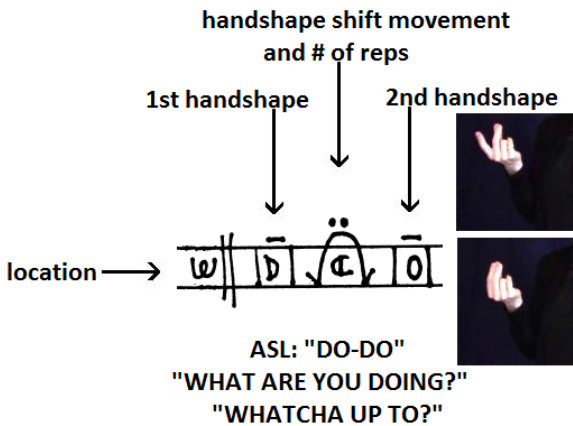


"EQUAL" (MIRROR NOTATION)

NOTE: The sign "equal" can be articulated in many ways, this is just one specific articulation. Each variation can also be notated.

PARAMETER #1

HANDSHAPES



HANDSHAPES

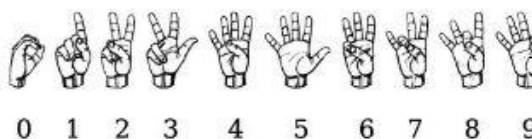
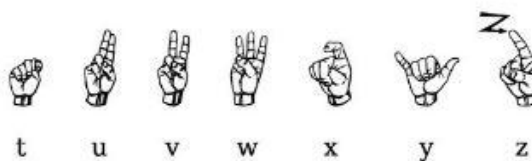
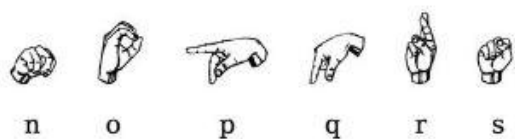
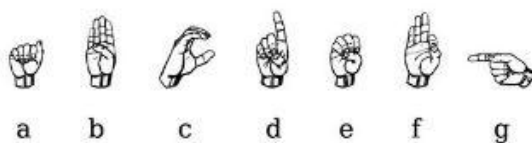
Many of the handshapes used in sign language are either

- **Alphabetical letters**

or

- **Numbers**

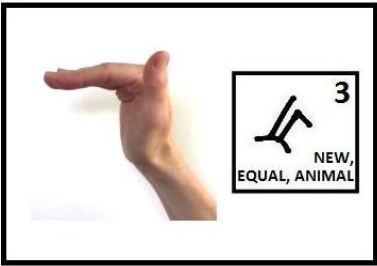
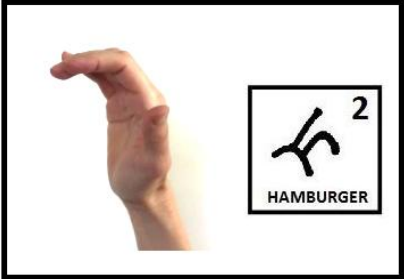
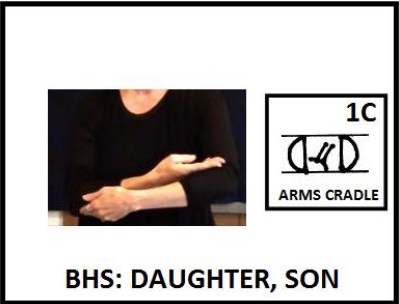
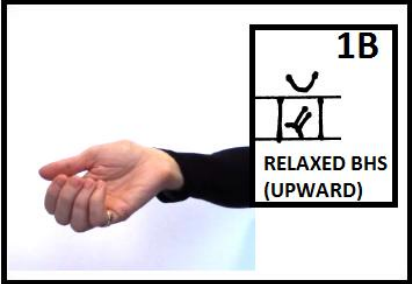
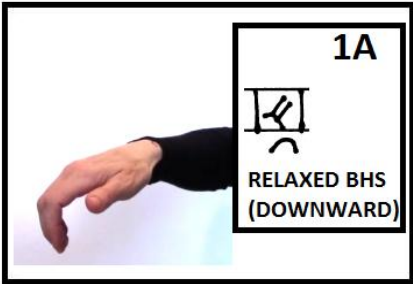
We will use these handshapes along with a set of symbols to represent 57 more unique handshapes.

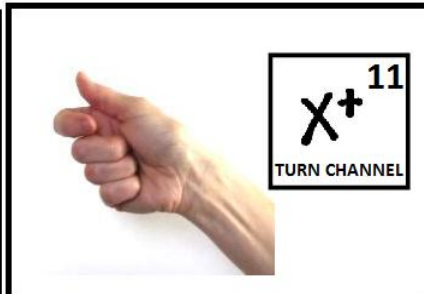
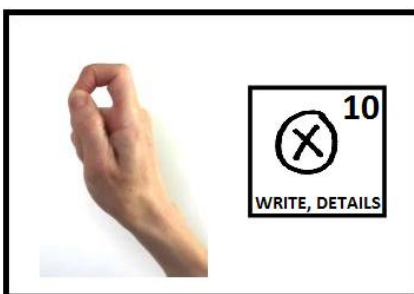
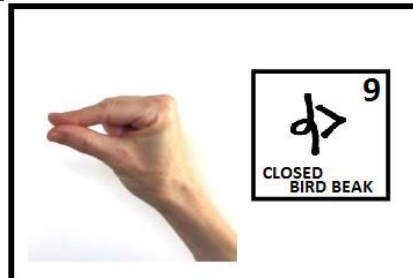
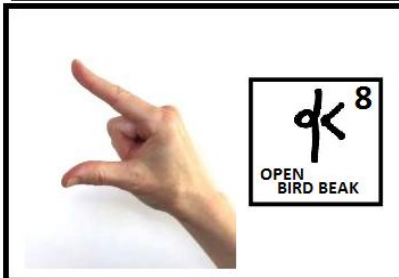
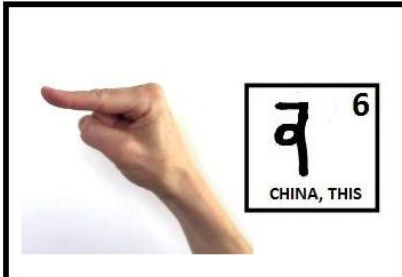
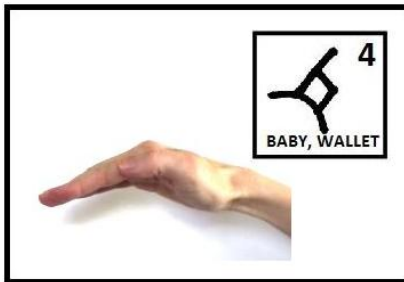


an example of handshapes and cre

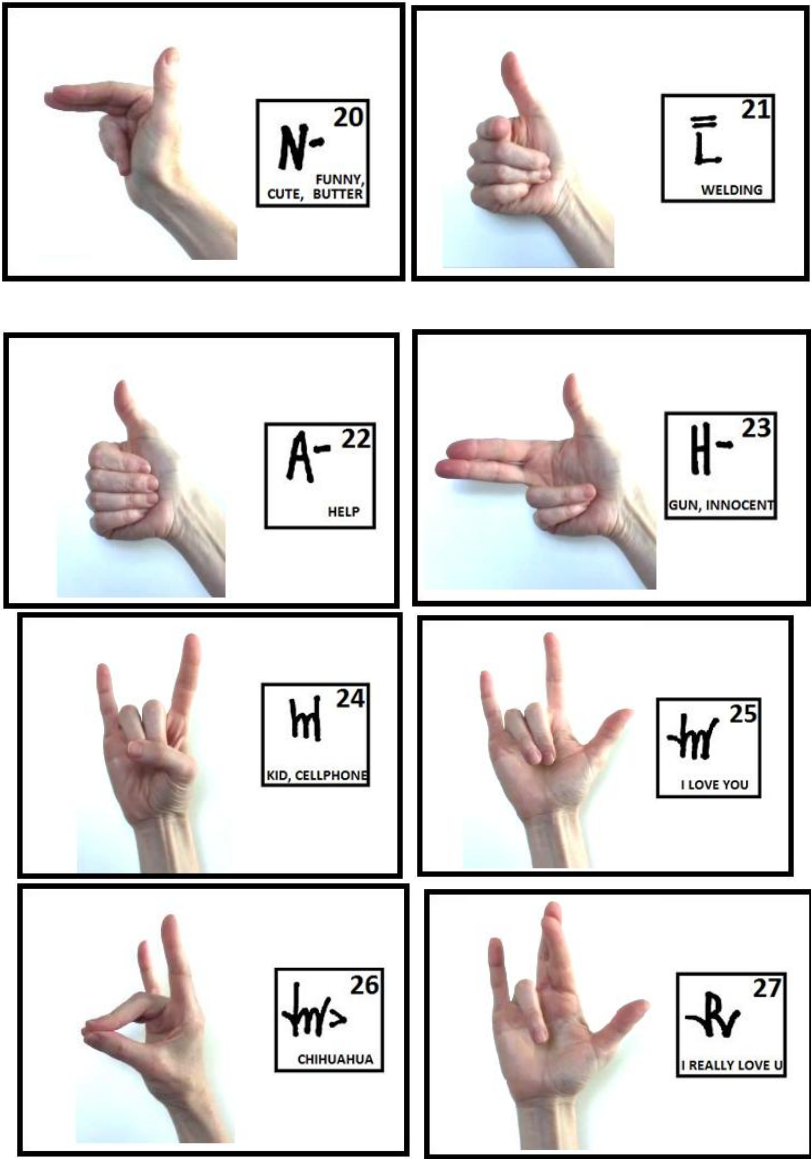
The following list is an example of handshapes and created symbols to represent those uniquely discernible handshapes along with sample sign references. A similar approach could be used for any sign language globally. Create a standard symbol to represent a specific, sign-bound handshape.

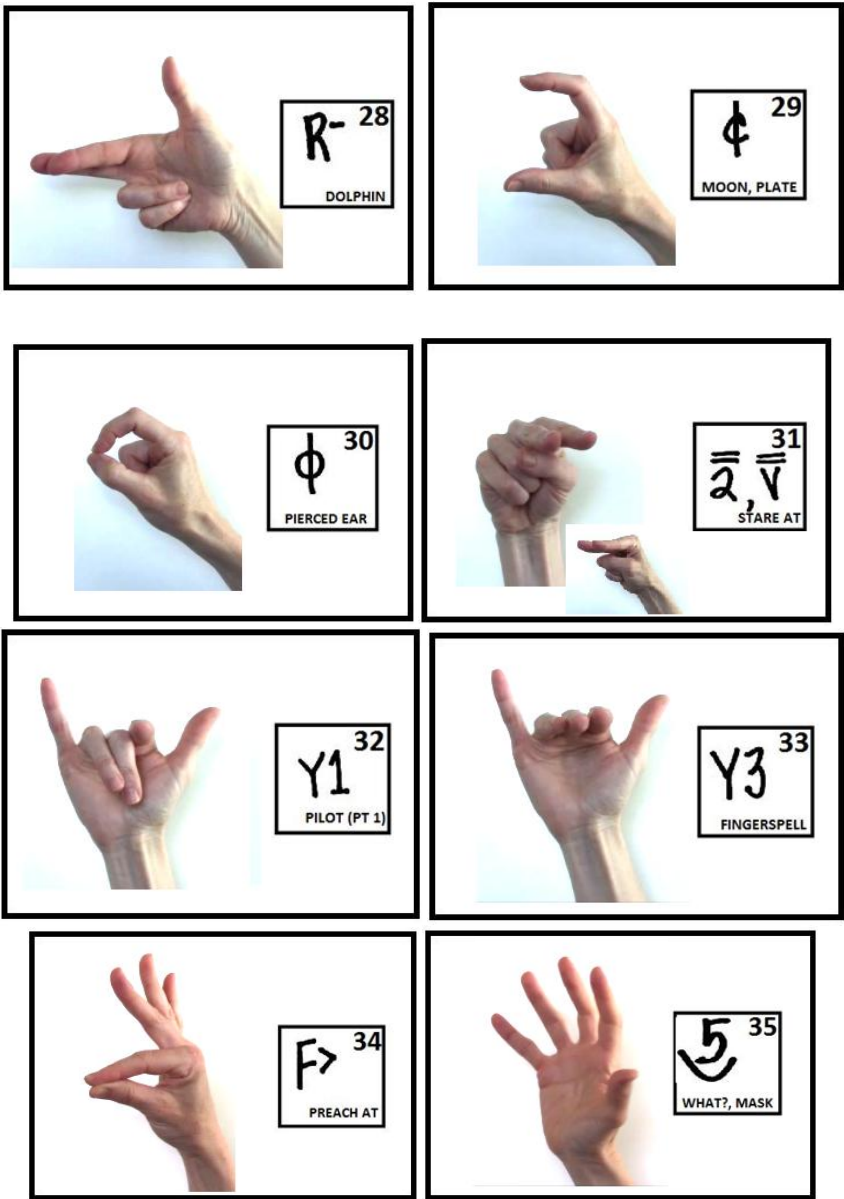
© 2014 Todd Helmenstein
t.helmenstein@shaw.ca

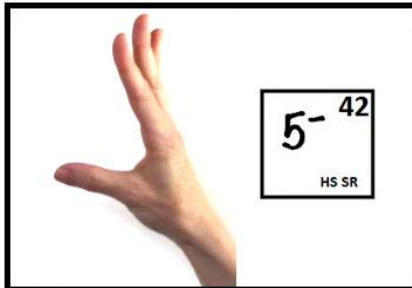
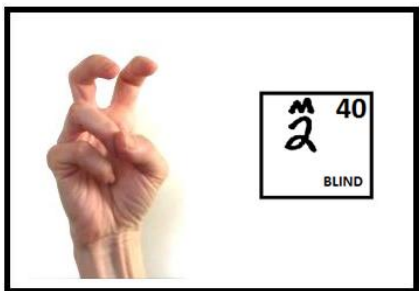
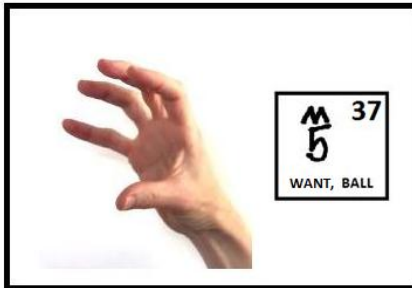




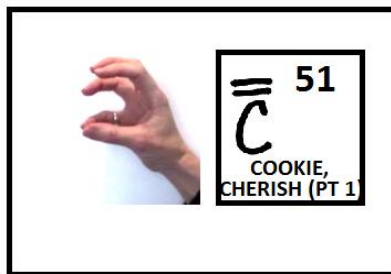
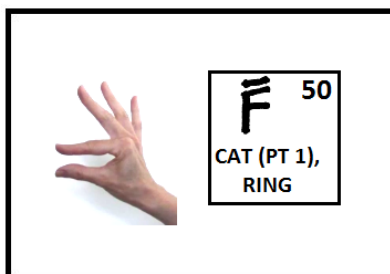
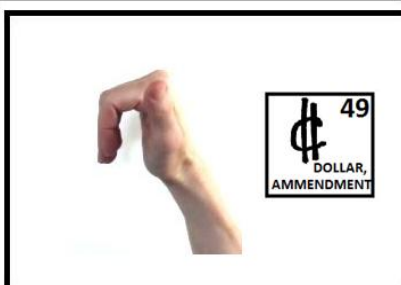
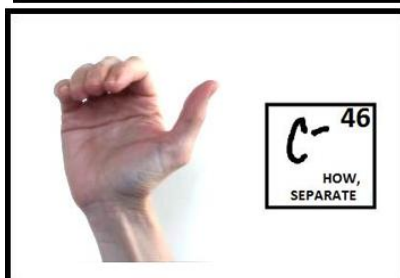
	X⁻12 WHO, RUN		8⁻13 HS SOPH FEEL, INTERNET
	8⁻14 LIKE (PT 1)		5⁻15 WOLF (PT 1)
	0^{>}16 TEACH, MORE		0⁻17 BOY (PT 1)
	N⁻18 NO (PT 1)		N^{>}19 NO (PT 2)





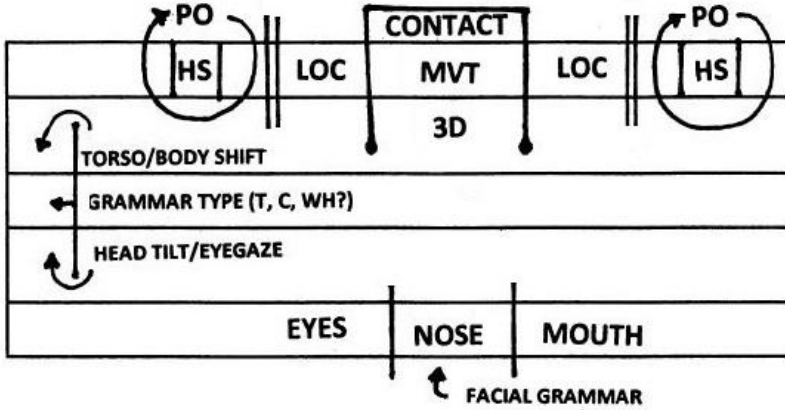


SIGNOTATION ASL WRITER'S GUIDE



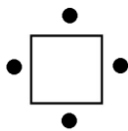
PARAMETER #2

PALM ORIENTATION

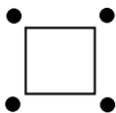


VERTICAL PALM ORIENTATION (VPO)

VPO is marked by a dot on the outside perimeter of the HS block:



BASIC PO (R,L,F,B)

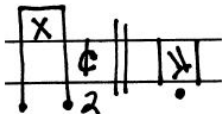


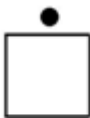
ANGLED PO

Examples:

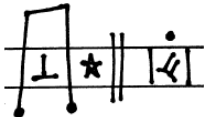

PO back: "MY"




"MY"

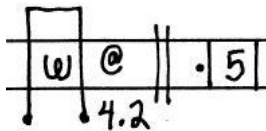

PO forward: "YOUR"

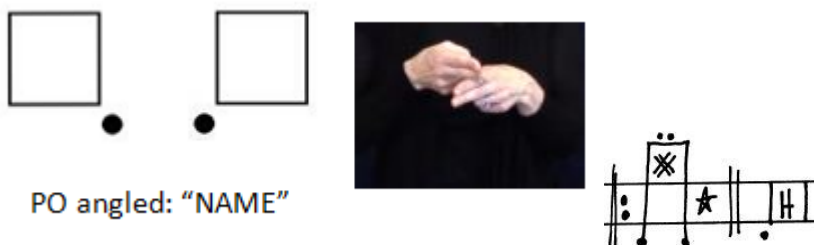



"YOUR"


PO left: "MOTHER"




4.2



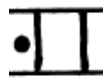
HORIZONTAL PALM ORIENTATION (HPO)

HPO is marked by a solid line below or above the HS block:

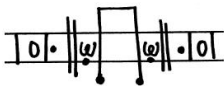


PALM ORIENTATION: SETTINGS

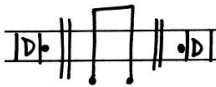
The default orientation of a handshape is based on its **alphabetical position**. Since the wrist can rotate but still have the same palm orientation, we need to notate the wrist rotation. When the palm orientation stays the same but the handshape has rotated we can notate these shifts in settings, which rotate clockwise.



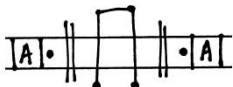
PO TO THE MIDLINE



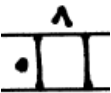
"MORE"
P.O. TO THE MIDLINE



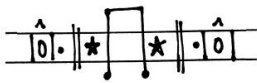
"DATE"
P.O. TO THE MIDLINE



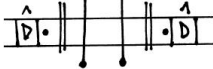
"PURSE"
P.O. TO THE MIDLINE



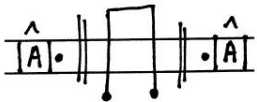
PO SETTING 1



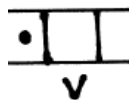
"MORE"
P.O. SETTING 1



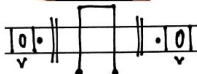
"DESSERT"
P.O. SETTING 1



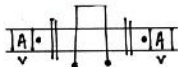
"WITH"
P.O. SETTING 1



P.O. SETTING 2

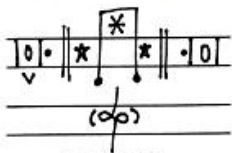


"OVARIES"
P.O. SETTING 2



"CRUTCHES"
P.O. SETTING 2

COMBINATION PO (MIDLINE AND SETTING 2)

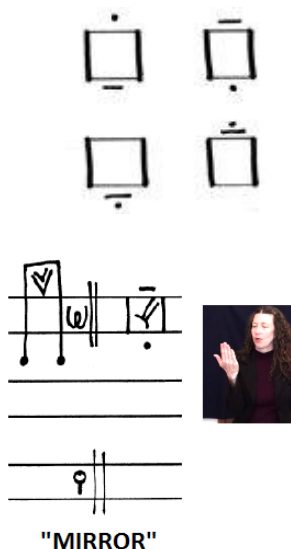


"NUMBER"
P.O. MIDLINE AND
SETTING 2
ALTERNATING MVT

(a lateral alternating HS caused by the rotation of the PO)

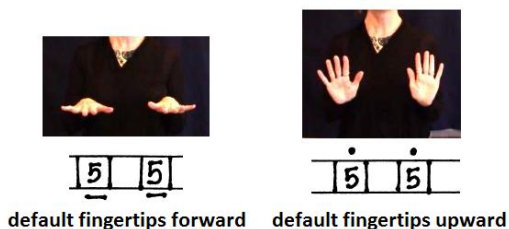
45 DEGREE TILT

Some signs have a slanted PO. An upward or downward tilt in fingertip orientation from the “sky” or “ground”. P.O. is notated using a combination of the palm orientations:



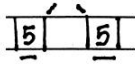
FINGERTIP DIRECTION

The default for handshape fingertip direction is pointing forward away from the signer, or upward towards the sky.

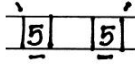


The fingertip direction is related to palm orientation and settings. It may be helpful or at times necessary to notate the fingertip directions using a simple “tic” mark for angled handshapes such as the sign for name:

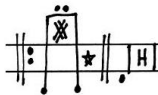
S HANSEN



fingertips angled inward



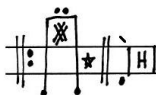
fingertips angled outward



"NAME"



without fingertip mark

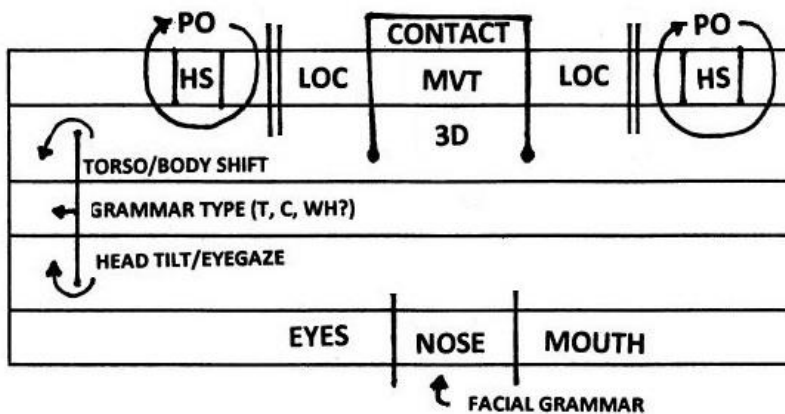
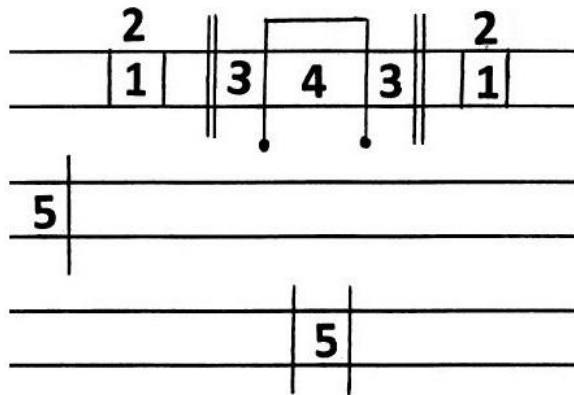


"NAME"



with fingertip mark

PARAMETER #3 LOCATION



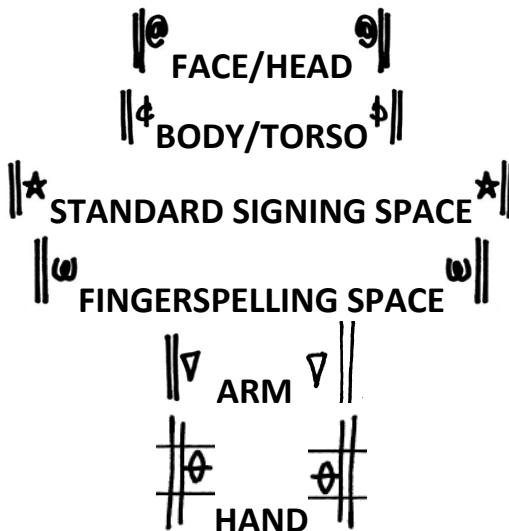
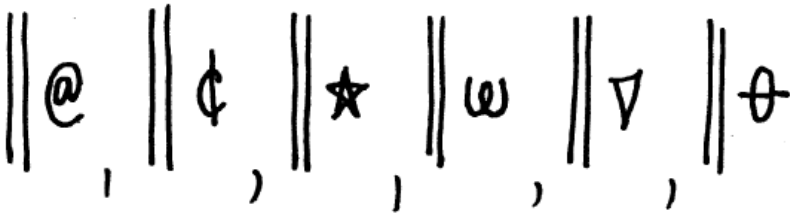
THE 3-DIMENSIONS OF ASL

1D  VERTICAL

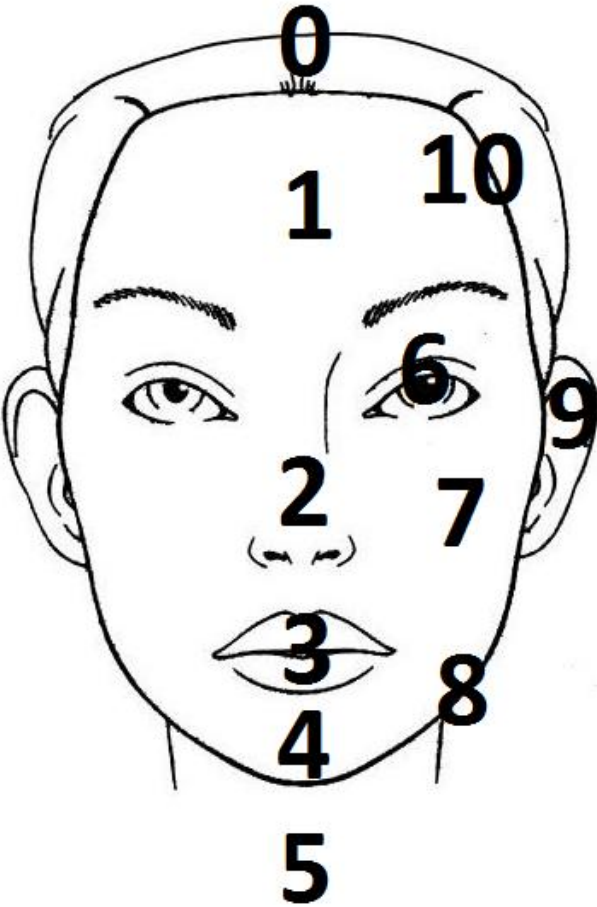
2D  LATERAL

3D  HORIZONTAL

5 BASIC LOCATIONS:

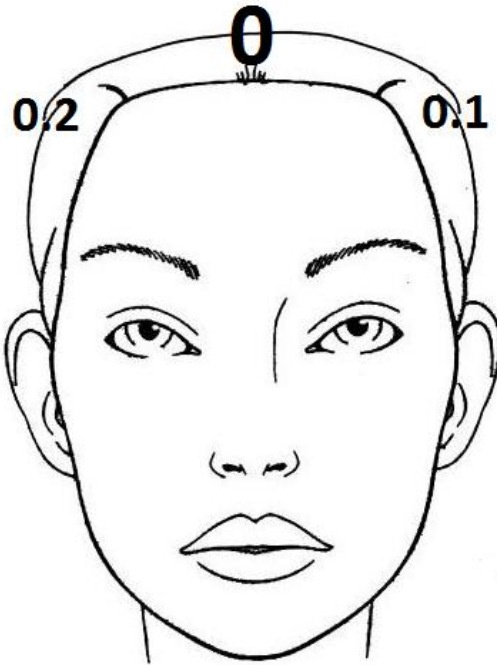


|@ FACE/HEAD LOCATIONS **@|**
PRIMARY



FACE/HEAD LOCATIONS *SECONDARY*

CROWN



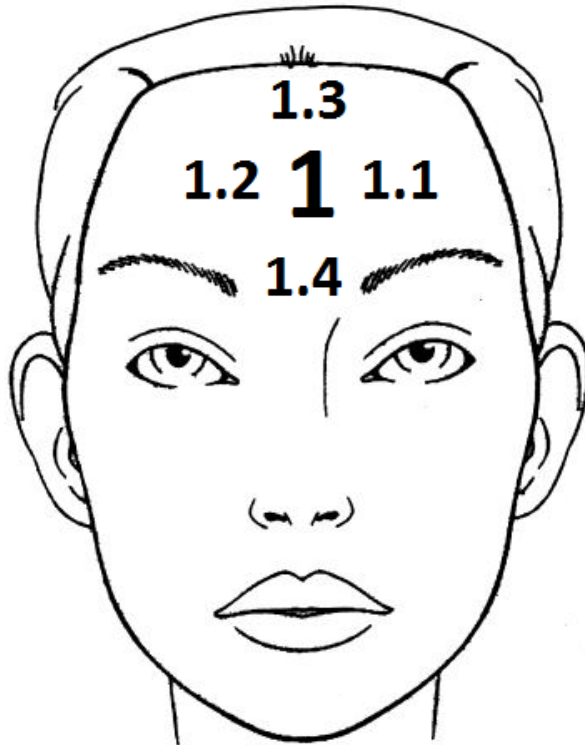
SAMPLES:

0 = "hat"

.2 = "lettuce"

.1 and .2 = "deer"

FOREHEAD



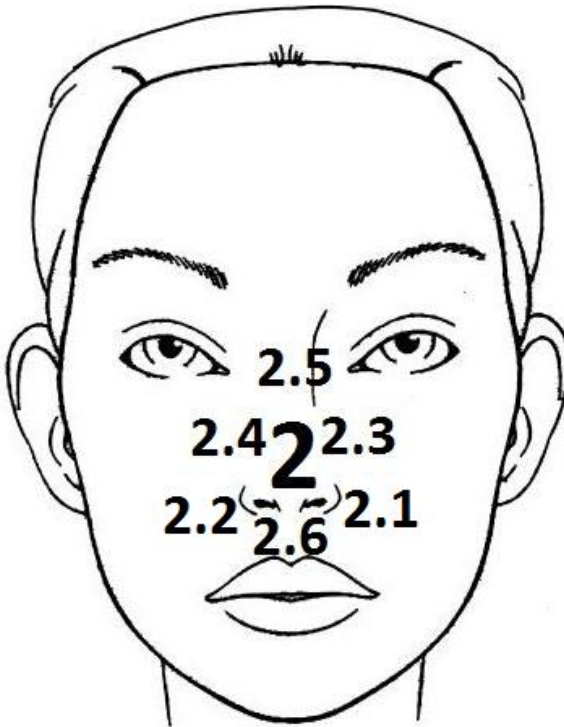
SAMPLES:

1 = "smart"

1.1 - 1.2 = "forget"

1.3 - 1.4, 1.1 - 1.2 = "Pepsi"

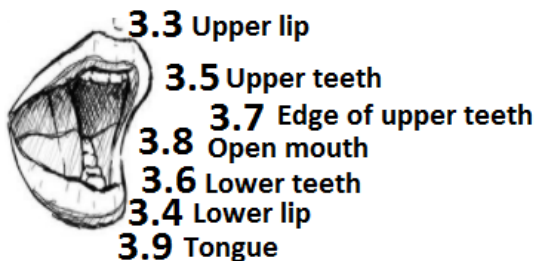
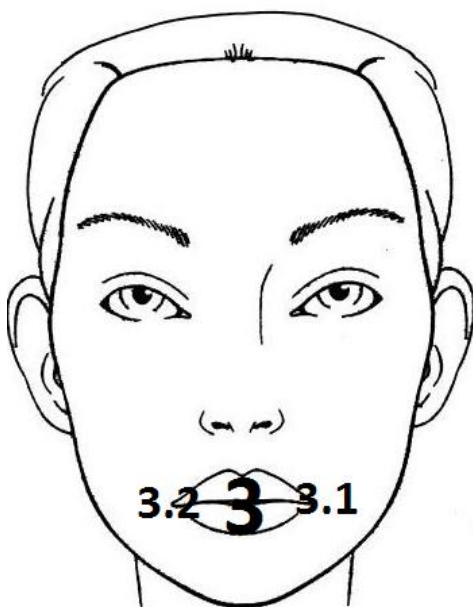
NOSE



SAMPLES:

2 = "mouse"
2.1 - 2.2 = "flower"
2.1 and 2.2 = "boring"
2.1 - 2.2 = "deaf-nose" (can't smell)
2.3 or 2.4 "brown-nose"
2.5 = "nerd"
2.6 = "kid"

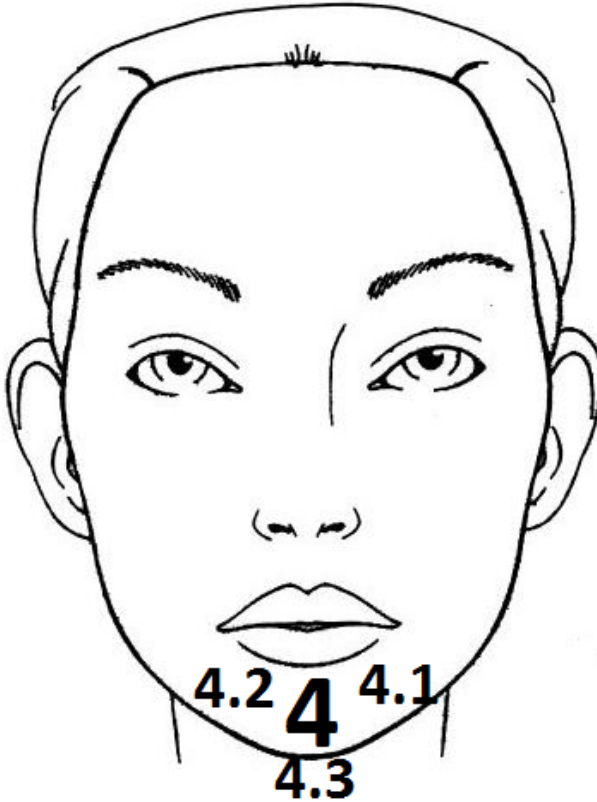
MOUTH



SAMPLES:

3 = "talk", "shhh"
3.1 - 3.2 = "zip lips"
3.2 = "water, lemon"
3.3 = "apply lipstick"
3.4 = "red", "hearing", "taste"
3.5 = "glass"
3.6 = "lower teeth"
3.7 = "nut"
3.8 = "sucks"
3.9 = "stick your tongue out"

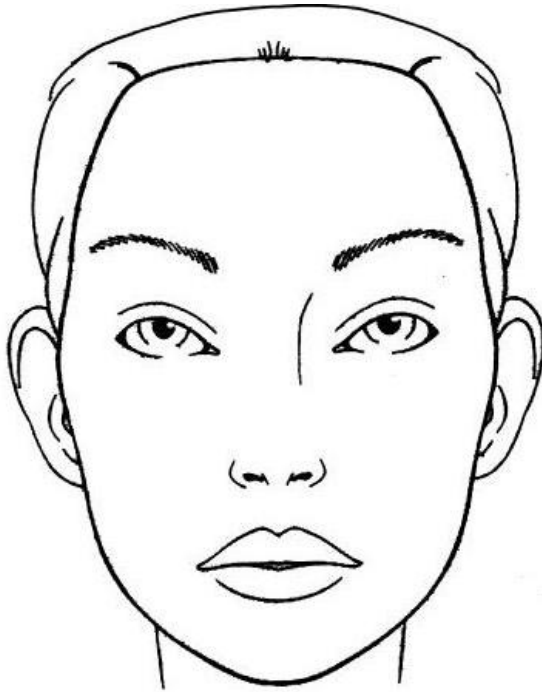
CHIN



SAMPLES:

4 = "favorite", "who", "orange"
4.1 and 4.2 = "honeymoon"
4.2 = "mother/mama"
4.3 = "not", "dirty"

NECK



5.3
5.2 **5** 5.1
5.4

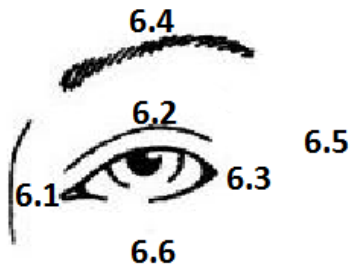
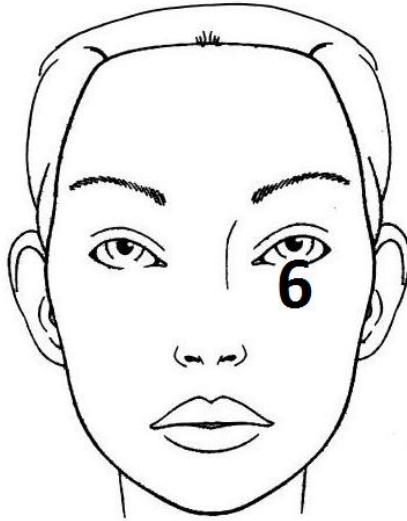
SAMPLES:

5 = "turn off voice"

5.1 - 5.2 = "thyroid" or "choke on car"

5.3 - 5.4 = "thirsty"

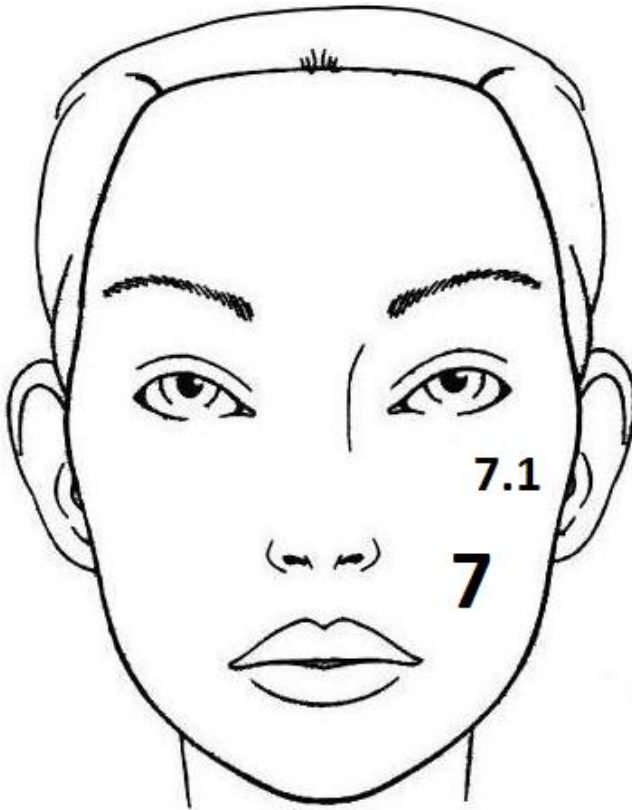
EYE



SAMPLES:

- 6 = "eye", "contacts" (part 2), "pirate"
- 6.1 = "inside corner of eye"
- 6.2 = "eye lid"
- 6.3 = "outer corner of eye", "bright eyes" name sign
- 6.4 = "black"
- 6.5 = "Dad" or "Mom"
- 6.6 = "cry", "tears", "seeing is proof/witness"

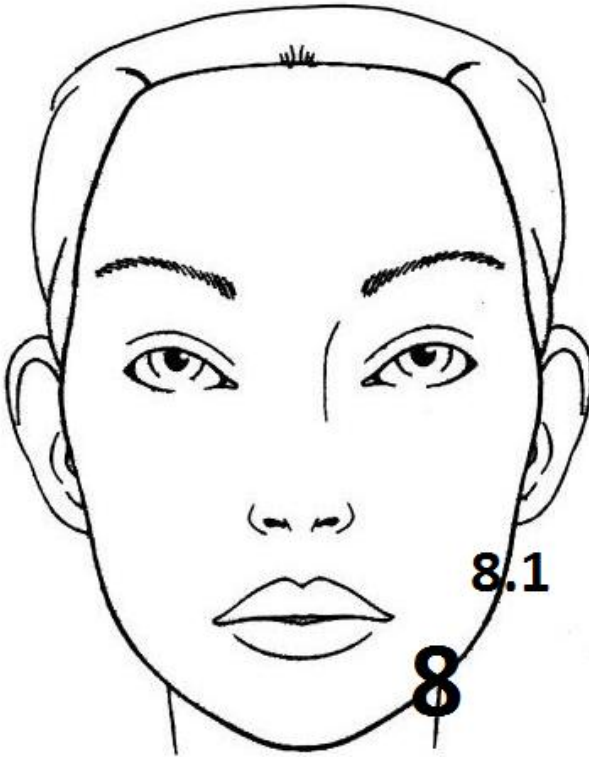
CHEEKS



SAMPLES:

7 = "cat", "candy", "home" (pt.1)
7.1 = "see" (cheekbone)

JAW



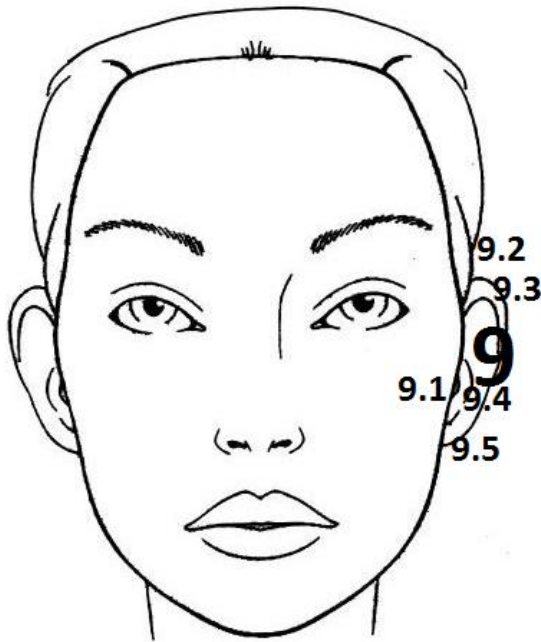
SAMPLES:

8 = "tomorrow", "wife", "sister"

8.1 = "wisdom teeth",

8.1 - 8 = "girl"

EAR



9.6 Behind the ear

SAMPLES:

9 = "listen with ears", "the ear"

9.1 - 4 = "deaf"

9.2 = "hearing aid"

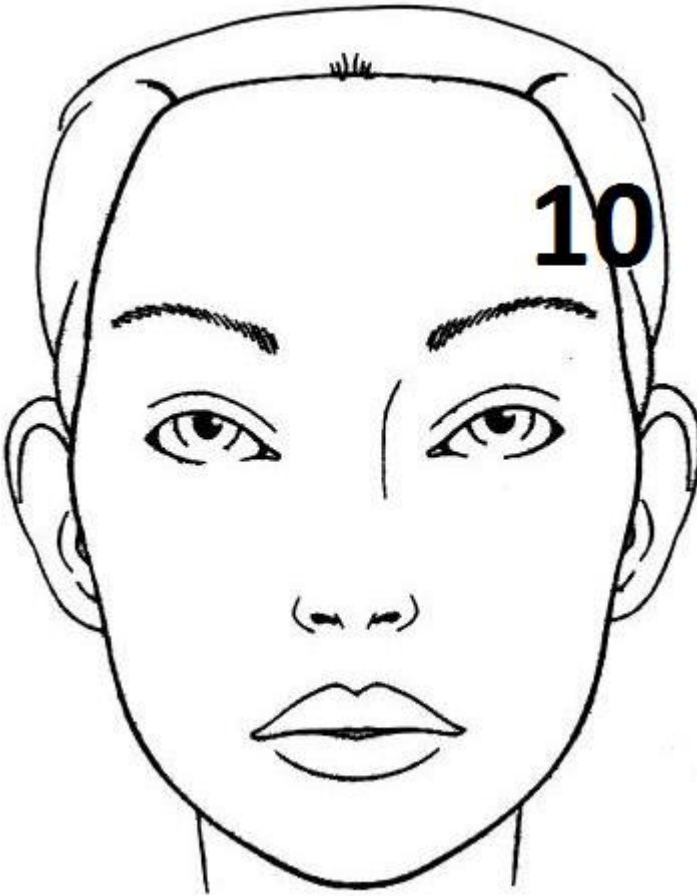
9.3 = "top of the ear"

9.4 = "ear mold"

9.5 = "foul"

9.6 = "cochlear implant"

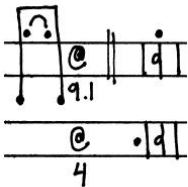
TEMPLE



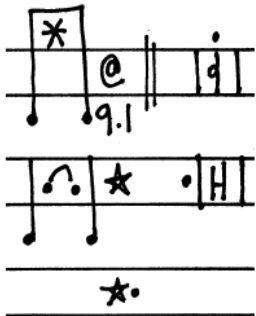
SAMPLES:

10 = "Father", "mind/think", "common sense", "cow", "horse"

SAMPLE SIGN LOCATIONS: FACE/HEAD

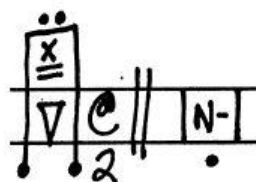


"DEAF"

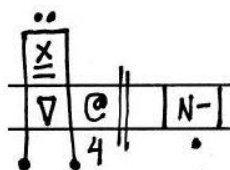


"HARD OF HEARING"

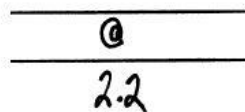
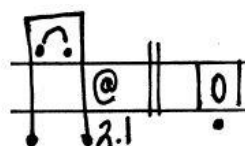




"FUNNY"
"AMUSING"



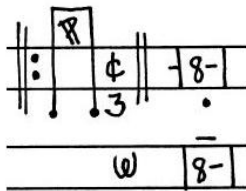
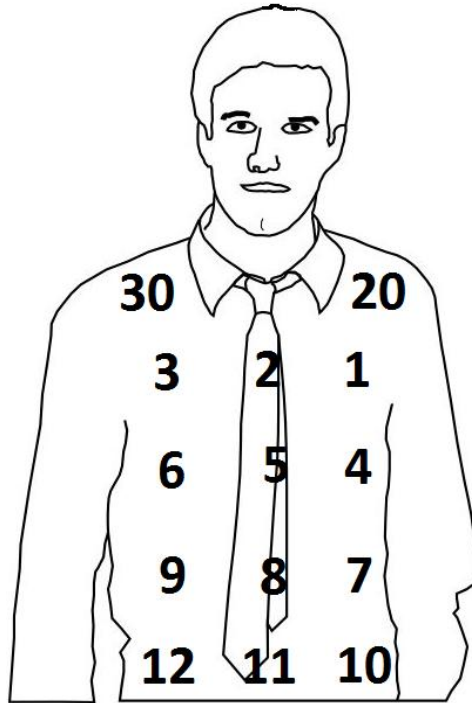
"CUTE"
"DARLING"
"ADORABLE"



"FLOWER"
"POSY"



||¢ TORSO LOCATIONS ¢||

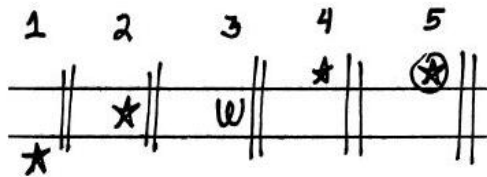


"WHAT'S UP"

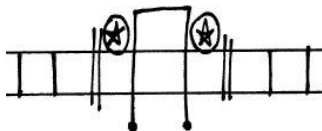
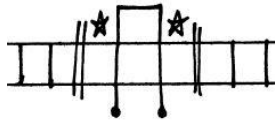
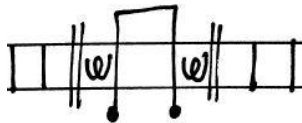
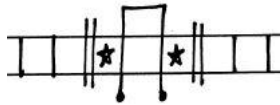
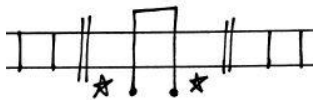


(MIRROR MOVEMENT NOTATION)

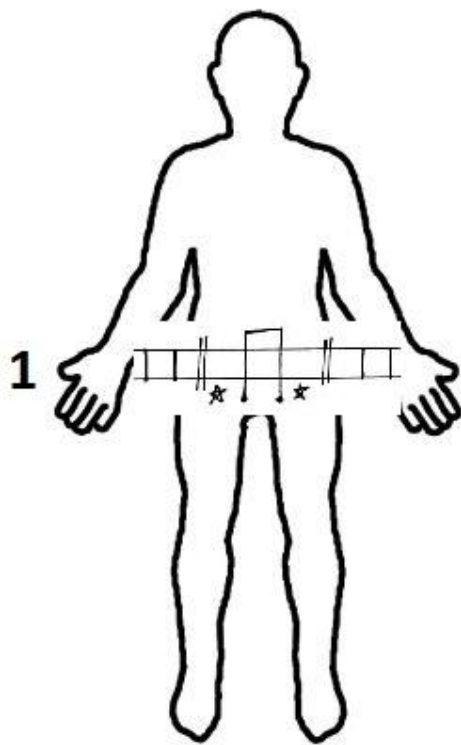
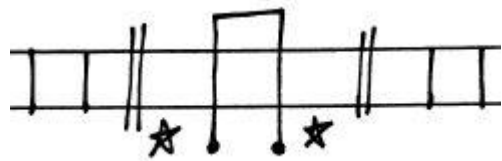
1D VERTICAL LOCATIONS #1-5



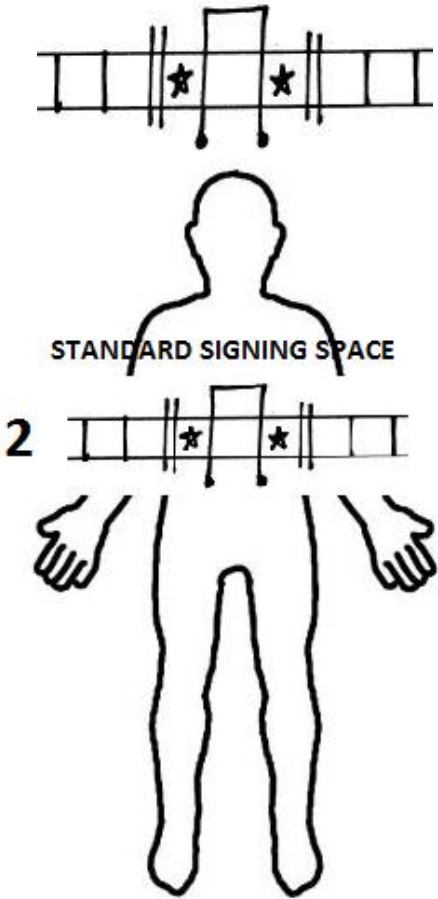
The **vertical plane** is the first dimension. There are five main sections or zones that exist for the signer vertically. Each is approximately a handbreadth apart. These locations are:



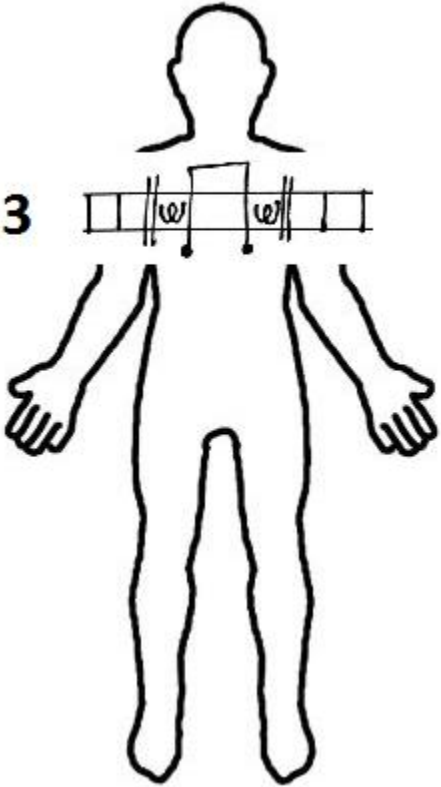
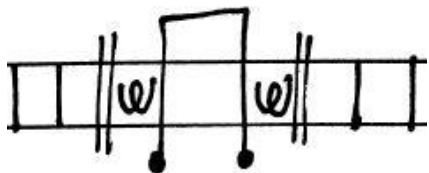
VERTICAL LOCATION #1



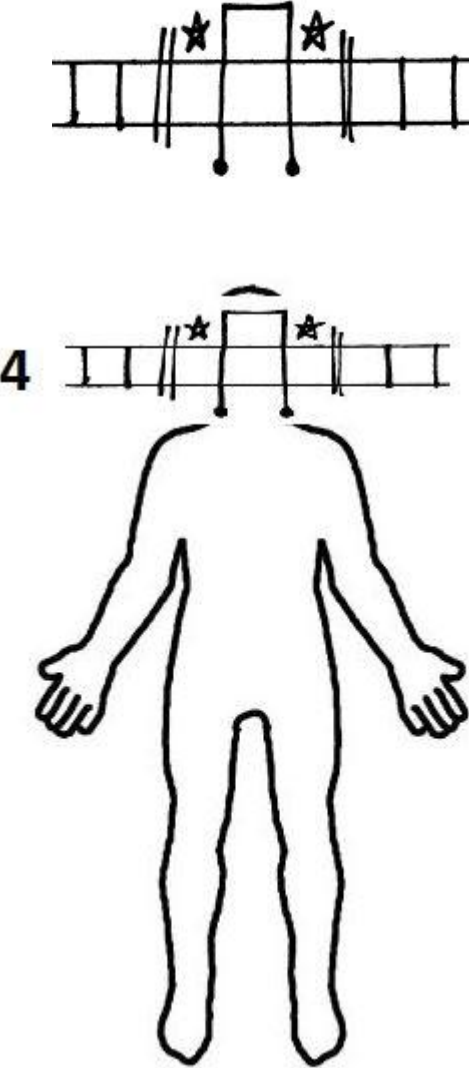
VERTICAL LOCATION #2 (STANDARD SIGNING SPACE)



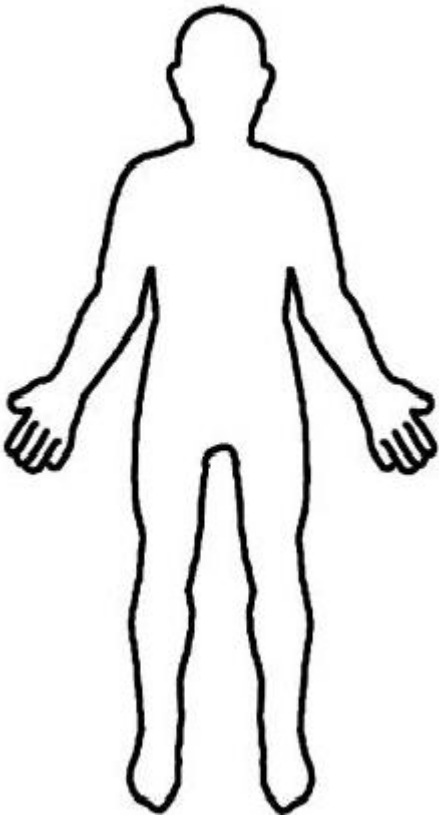
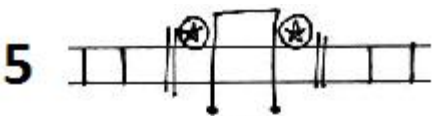
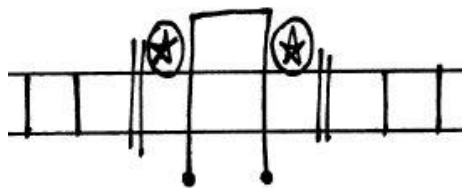
**VERTICAL LOCATION #3
(FINGERSPELLING LOCATION)**



VERTICAL LOCATION #4



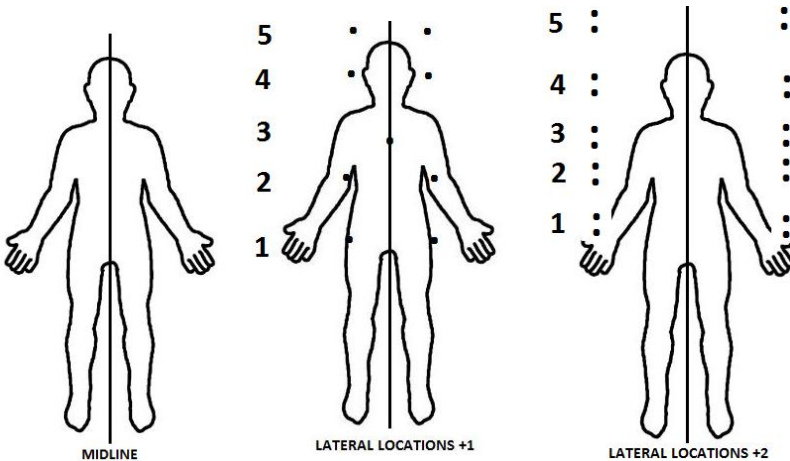
VERTICAL LOCATION #5



2D ✚ LATERAL LOCATIONS

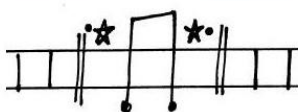
The **midline or lateral plane** is the second dimension. There are three main sections or zones that exist for the signer symmetrically based on the midline. Each is approximately a handbreadth apart. These locations are:

- THE MIDLINE (default vertical position except for fingerspelling location)
- LATERAL LOCATION +1 (the side or arm section)
Note: the fingerspelling location moves to the midline
- LATERAL LOCATION +2 (The outer region, beyond the perimeter of the body)

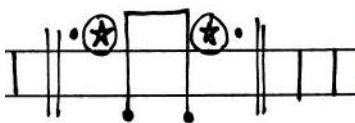


SAMPLE SIGN LOCATIONS:

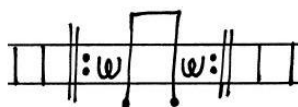
NOTE: The following sign locations are for demonstration purposes and particular signs can be moved to different locations and notated accordingly. For example, the sign "play" can also be signed over the head, in the standard signing space, or lower in vertical location #1, and signed with one or both hands.



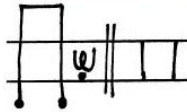
"YAY HANDS WAVING" LOC



"BASKETBALL"



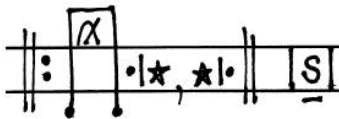
"PLAY" LOC



"ONE MORE" LOC

SUBDIVIDING LOCATIONS:

To subdivide a location, you can use the directional notations for up, down, right, left etc... and use a comma to show the specific locations. For example the signs for “the same” and “shoe” occur in the left and right hand sections of the standard signing space:

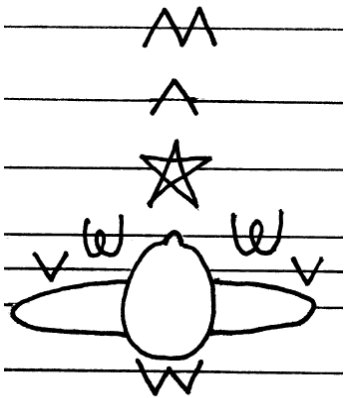


"SHOE"

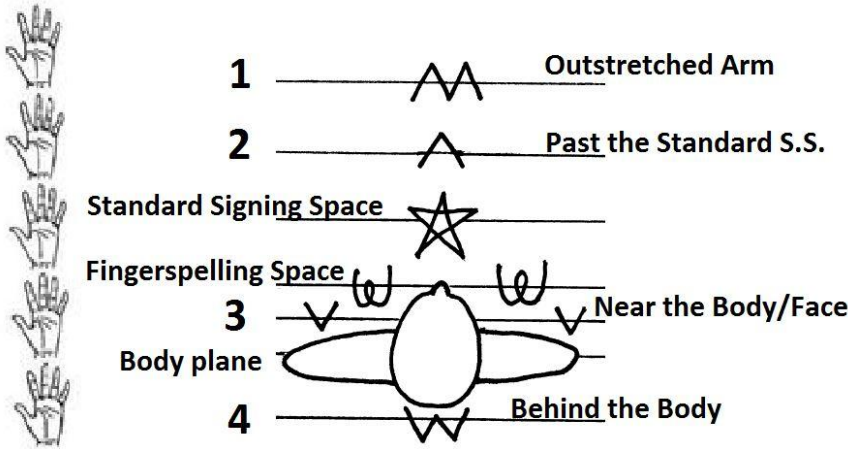


3D HORIZONTAL LOCATIONS

The **horizontal plane** is the third dimension. Movements forward or back add the final layer of spatial detail. The 3-D aspect for the standard signing space, fingerspelling and the body plane are embedded. Below are the remaining 4 areas of the horizontal plane:

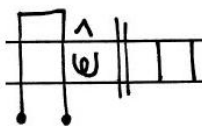


Here is a more detailed look at that set of locations:

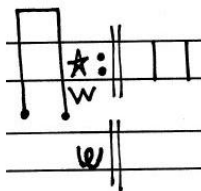


SAMPLE SIGN LOCATIONS:

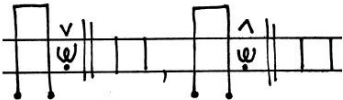
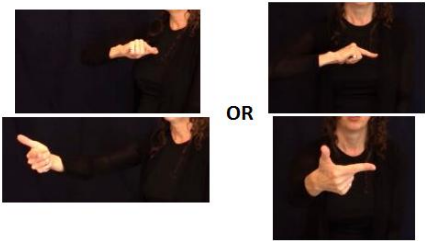
NOTE: The following sign locations are for demonstration purposes and particular signs can be moved to different locations and notated accordingly.



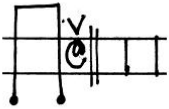
"WHERE" LOC



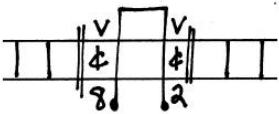
PERSON WALKS UP FROM
RIGHT REAR TO
FINGERSPELLING SPACE



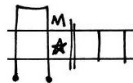
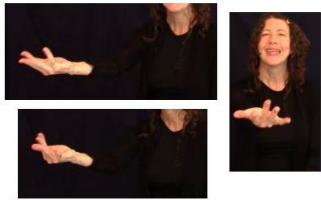
"MY TURN, YOUR TURN" LOC



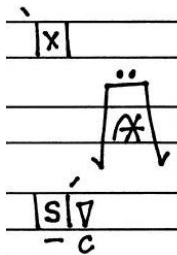
"SILLY" LOC
"RIDICULOUS"



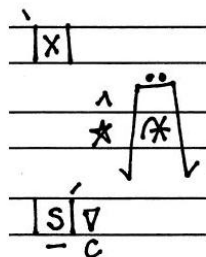
"AFRAID" LOC
"SCARED"
"FRIGHTENED"



"WAIT" LOC



"TIME" (2)

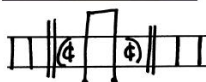


"TIME" (2)
FORWARD LOCATION



(BASE HANDSHAPE PAIR) SIDE LOCATION

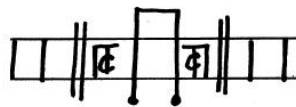
The side of the torso, for example the sign: "monkey".



"MONKEY" LOC

ARMPIT LOCATION

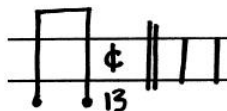
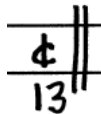
The side of the torso, for example the sign: “animal”.



"ANIMAL" LOC

HIP LOCATION

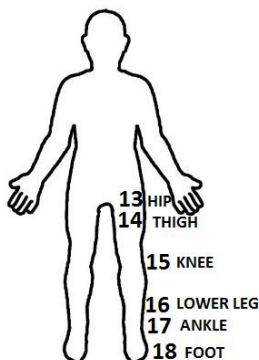
The side of the torso, for example the sign: “tail wagging”.



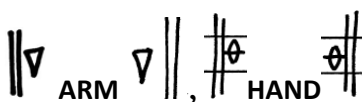
"TAIL" LOC

ADDITIONAL BODY LOCATIONS

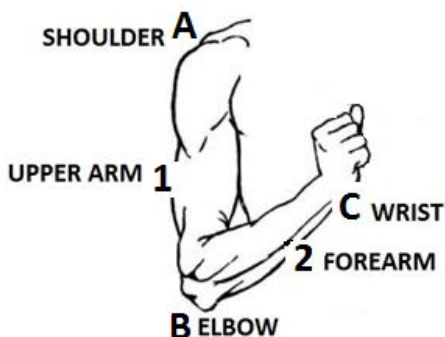
Additional locations can be created as needed for precise locations on the body.



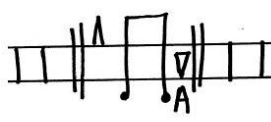
THE ARM AND HAND



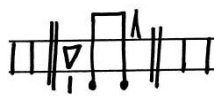
The arm and hands are composed of joints and bones. Starting at the shoulder, each **joint** is labeled alphabetically in uppercase: **A, B, C**. Beginning with the upper arm, each **bone** segment is labeled numerically: **1, 2**.



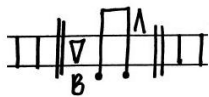
SAMPLE SIGN LOCATIONS: ARM



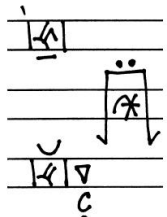
"RESPONSIBLE" LOC



"BLOOD PRESSURE" LOC

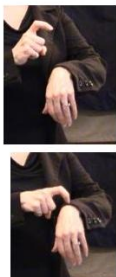
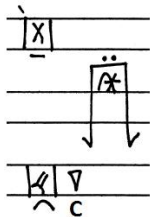


"TEMPTATION" LOC



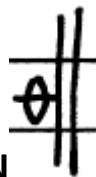
"DOCTOR" LOC
"PHYSICIAN"

(A BASE HANDSHAPE SIGN)



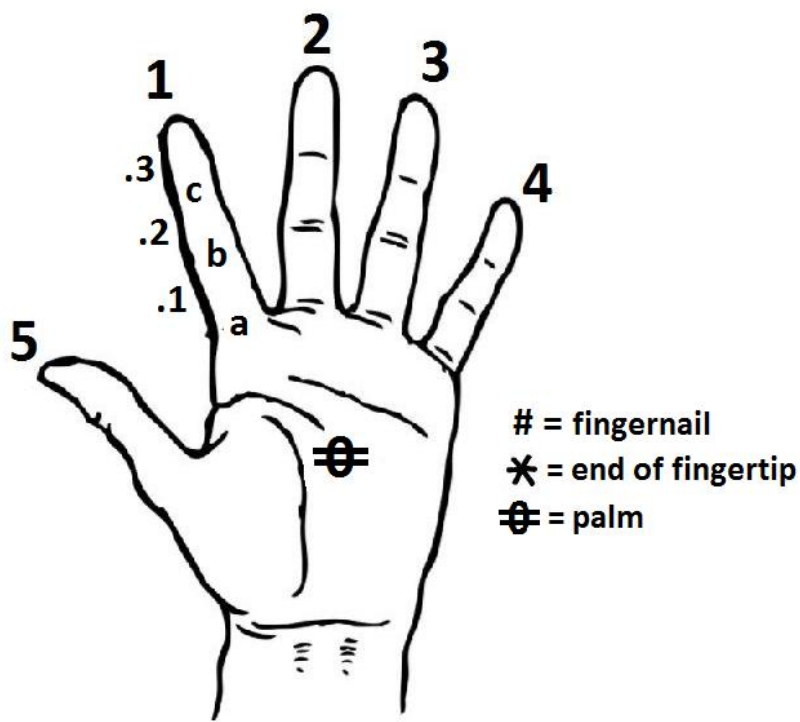
"TIME"

(A BASE HANDSHAPE SIGN)

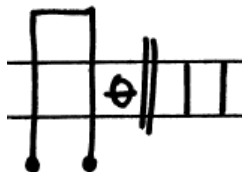


HAND AND FINGER IDENTIFICATION

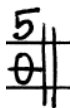
The fingers are numbered 1-5. Each of the three finger joints are labeled alphabetically lowercase: **a**, **b**, **c**. Each of the 3 finger bones are labeled numerically: **.1**, **.2**, **.3**. The palm is "**0**", and the fingernail = **#**. This allows the specific location on the finger to be accurately notated as needed.



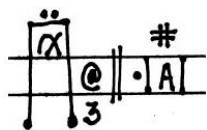
When recording on the SS staff, the **ARM**, **HAND** and **FINGER** locations critical for clear articulation will be listed **above** the applicable **HS block**.



FINGER LOCATION



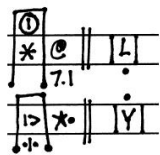
THUMB



- "SECRET"
- "PRIVATE"
- "PASS" (WORD)
- "CLANDESTINE"
- "CONFIDENTIAL"

A specific finger can also be indicated by using the finger number (1-5) circled either in the movement block or above or below the handshape. In the examples below the index or #1 finger is circled:

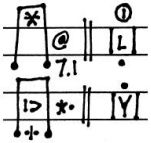
Example #1:



- "LOOK LIKE"
- "RESEMBLE"
- "SIMILAR"



Example #2:

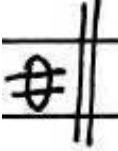




"LOOK LIKE"
"RESEMBLE"
"SIMILAR"

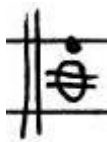
THE PALM



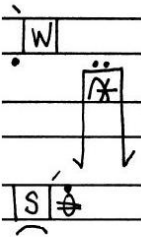


NON DOMINANT

DOMINANT



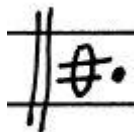
TOP SURFACE OF THE PALM IE: "WARRANT"



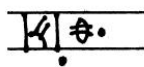
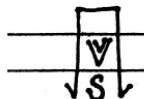
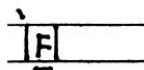


"WARRANT"

NOTE: FOR A BHSP, THE PALM CROSS SECTION IS THE
DEFAULT LOCATION FOR CONTACT



INSIDE EDGE OF ND PALM IE: "MEAT"



"MEAT"
"CONTENT" (SUBJECT)

THE FOUR FACES OF THE ARM

The four faces of the wrist and other arm locations use simple dots around the exterior of the location. Here are the four faces of the wrist:



"DUTY" LOC



"DOCTOR" LOC



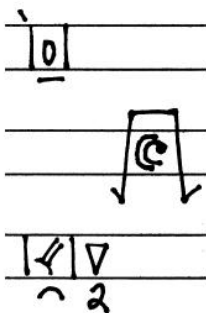
"CYST ON WRIST" (INSIDE)



"CYST ON WRIST" (OUTSIDE)



"HANDCUFF" LOC



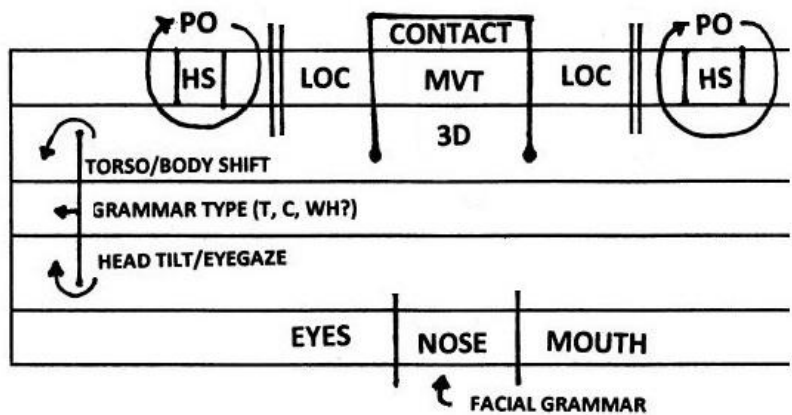
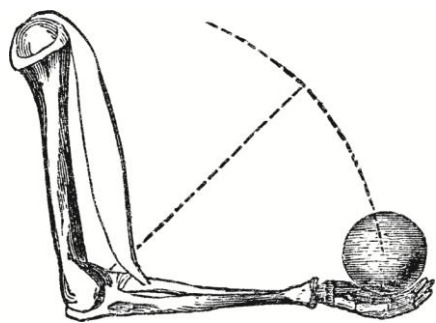
"X-RAY: WRIST"



PARAMETER #4

MOVEMENT

LINES AND WHEELS



MOVEMENTS KEY:

DM = DIRECTIONAL MOVEMENT

FM = FINGER MOVEMENT

M = MOVEMENT

CM = CONTACT MOVEMENT



DM = DIRECTIONAL MOVEMENT

3-D directional movement notations can stand alone as a direction for a sign movement, or in conjunction with another sign movement that requires a directional component.

Note: All of the following are samples of possible movement notations. They are experimental and can be re-designed by the Deaf Community to fit any particular, unique sign language movement.. Each movement must be connected to an actual sign in use. **Some movements require the addition of a direction, and some require more than one movement notation.** These are described as “embedded movements” in the Grammar Section that follows, (ie: baby, hurricane).

Movements are from the signer’s perspective or from the right side (see circular movements).

DIMENSION #1 VERTICAL

UP

DM:1



NORTH,
TALL, ROCKET LIFT-OFF





DOWN

DM:2

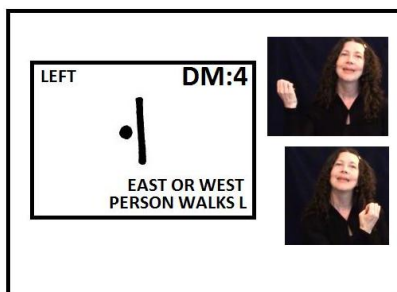
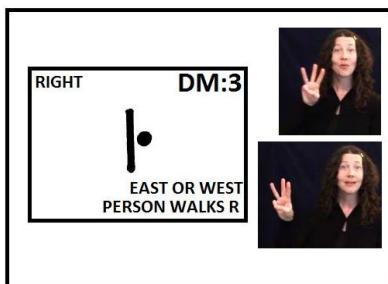


SOUTH,
THIRSTY, SNOW

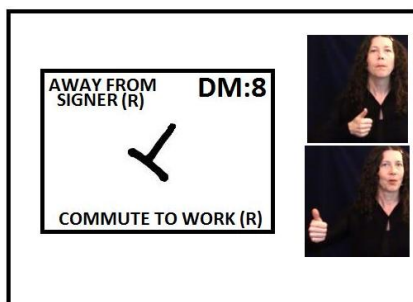
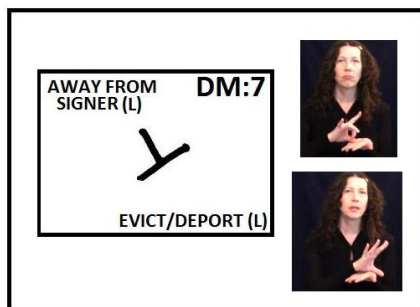
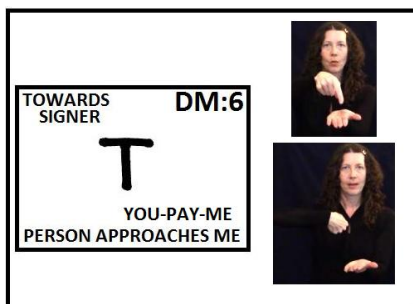


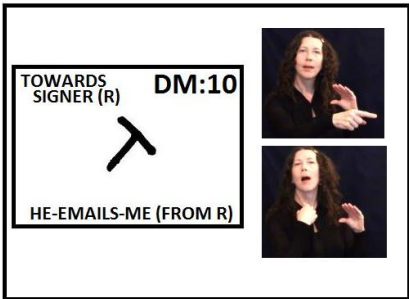
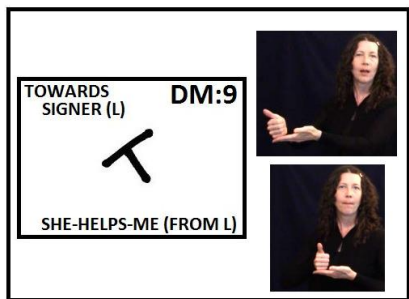


DIMENSION #2 LATERAL



DIMENSION #3 HORIZONTAL





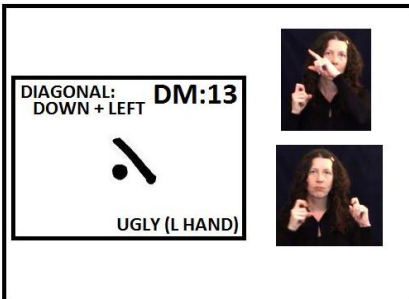
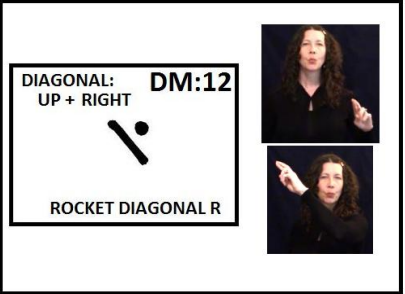
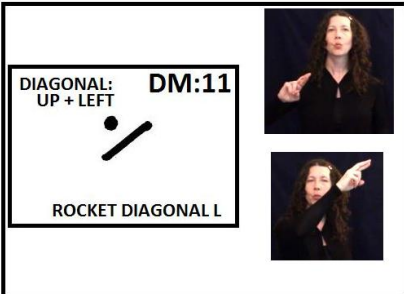
DIMENSIONS #1 & 2



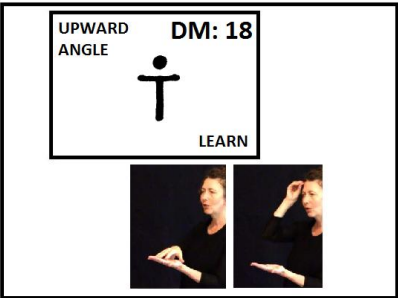
VERTICAL



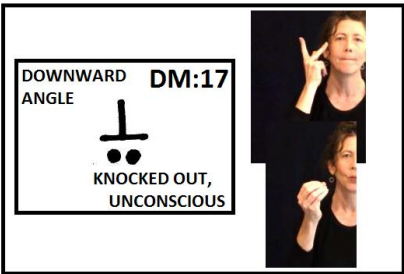
LATERAL



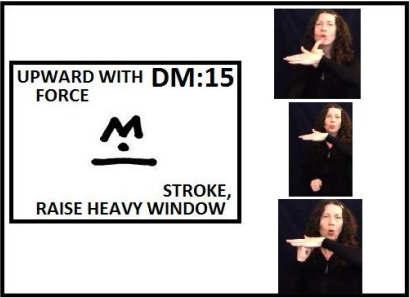
***TO ANGLE DIMENSION #3 UPWARD,
ADD 1 DOT**



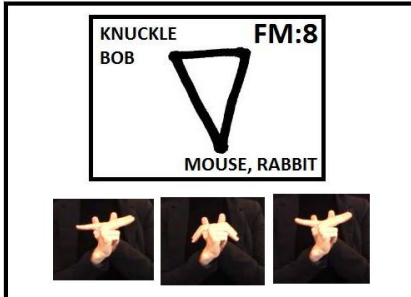
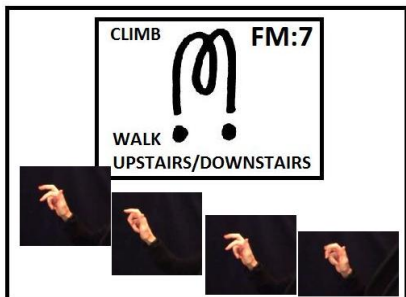
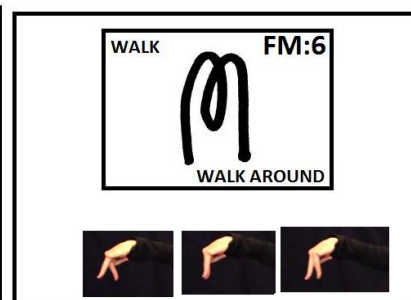
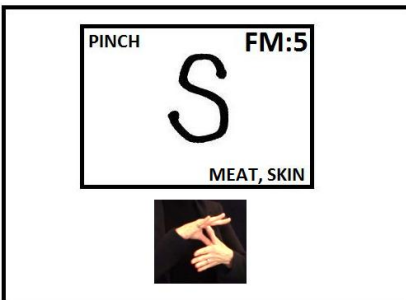
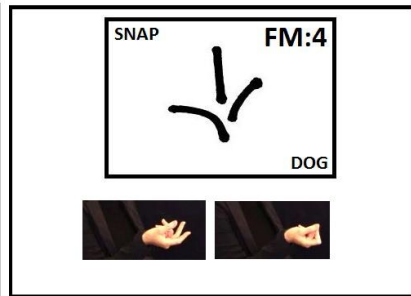
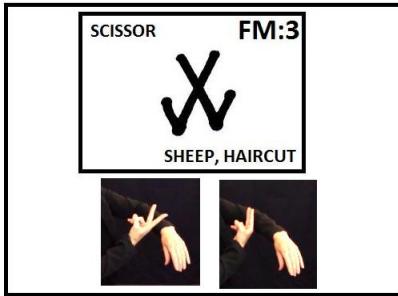
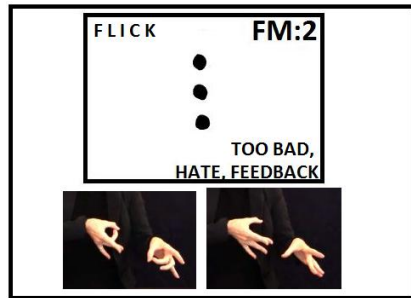
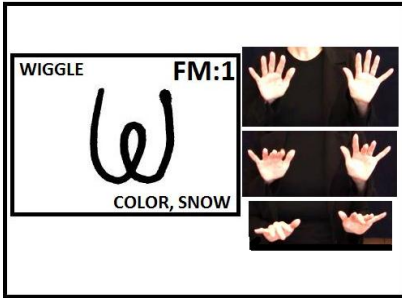
***TO ANGLE DIMENSION #3 DOWNWARD,
ADD 2 DOTS**



ADDING FORCE TO ANY DIRECTIONAL MOVEMENTS:



FM = FINGER MOVEMENT



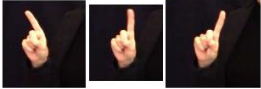
FINGER BOB 1X FM:9

! SNAP A PHOTO



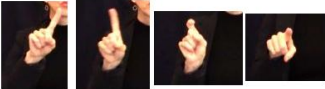
SIDE BOB FM:10

▷ "NO-NO" GESTURE



QUESTION MARK FM:11

? GOVERNMENT, ASK A QUESTION QQ



SQUEEZE IN PLACE REPEATEDLY FM: 12

! MAD, SPONGE, WANT, INSECT



M = MOVEMENT

HOP M:1

∩ DOLPHIN, CHILDREN HARD OF HEARING



VIBRATE M:2

∨ FISH, PLAY, FOR-FOR? BLUE, SILLY, FINISH MEDICINE, WHERE, MOVIE



BOUNCE M:3

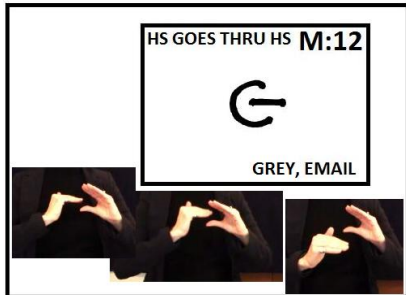
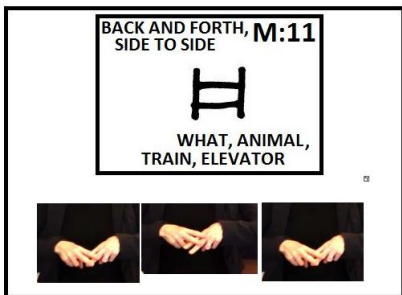
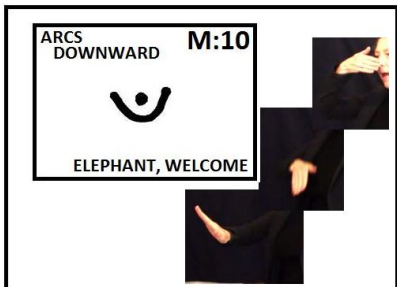
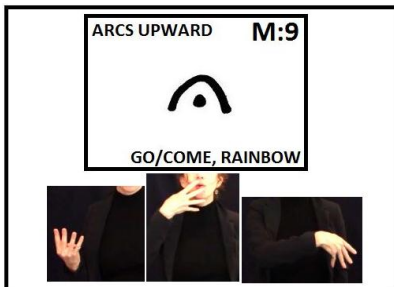
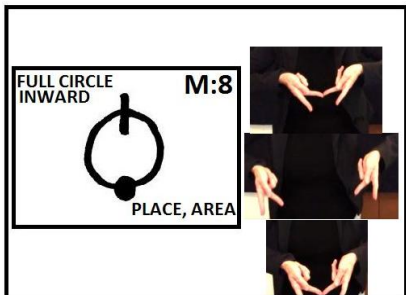
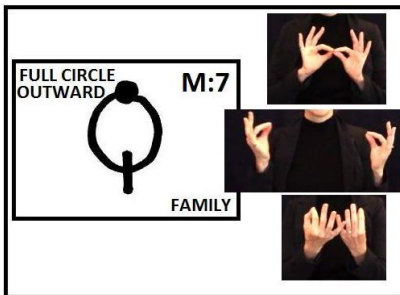
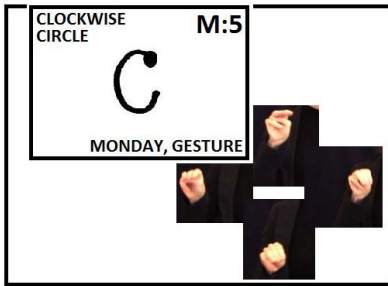
!! HAT, CHILD



WRIST NOD M:4

∪ YES, HAVE TO





HS GOES UNDER HS

M:13



SNEAK OUT, KICK, HIDE



HS ON TOP OF HS

M:14



CHAMP!
PUT ON A CHARACTER

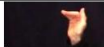


POKE

M:15



OWE \$,
TAP FOR ATTENTION



TWIST

M:16



KEY, COOL/NEAT,
VOICE OFF



THROW

M:17



ASL,
THROW OUT/GARBAGE



REVERSE THROW

M:18



AND, COPY,
LEARN, CATCH A BALL



WRIST FLIP

M:19



COOK, DIE



WRIST FLIP + ROLL

M:20



HOW, HAPPEN



WRIST FLIP FIRM M: 21
1X



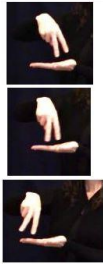
BLUE (FIRM), FINISH



WRIST ROCK SIDE-TO-SIDE M: 22



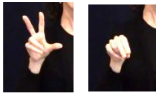
GREEN,
CHUBBY, DANCE, WOW



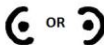
HS OPENS AND CLOSES M: 23



MILK, BIRD, NO



ARCS M: 24



CAR, TRUCK, PARIS



WRIST WAVE SIDE-TO-SIDE M: 25



BYE (WAVE), WHERE,
SIMILAR, ARGUE



SCOOP AND LIFT M: 26



NEW, WHAT'S UP?



SOFT "7" M: 27



NEVER, FUN, CHICAGO

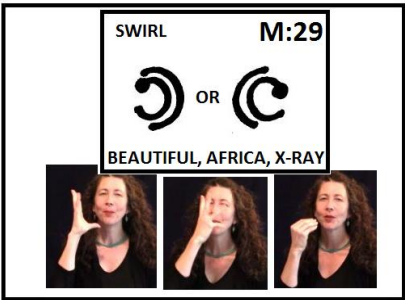


PARTIAL CIRCLE M: 28

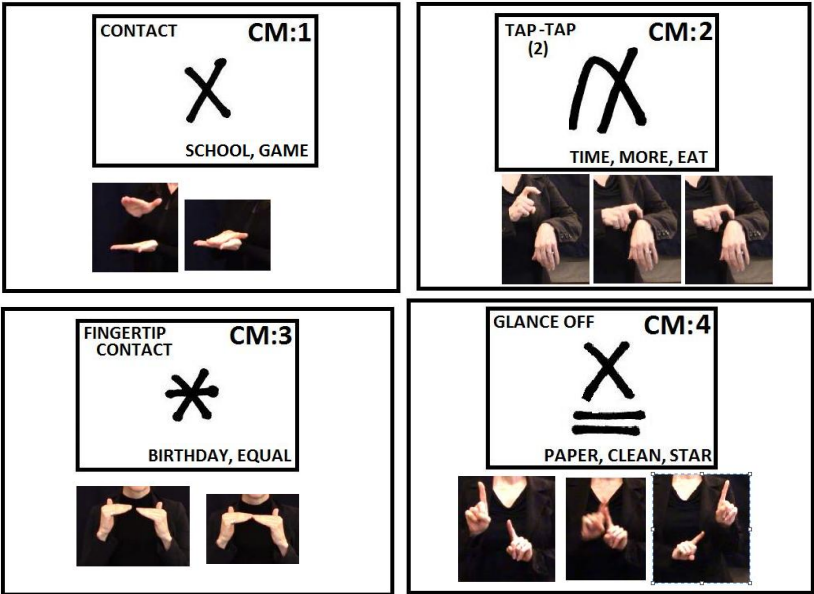


IMPORTANT





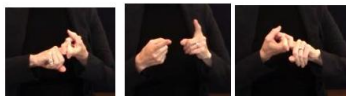
CM = CONTACT MOVEMENT



INTERTWINE CLASP CM:5



MARRIED
HAMBURGER, FRIEND



FINGERS INTERSECT CM:6



AMERICA



FINGERS INTERSECT AT BASE CM:7



PREGNANT, FOOTBALL



TAP-TAP (2) FINGERTIP CM:8



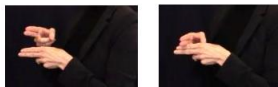
FAVORITE, MAMA, MORE



FINGERS OVERLAP CM:9



NAME



FINGERTIP GLANCE-OFF CM:10



I-PAD, CAT



HEAD/FACE GLANCE-OFF CM:11



GIRL,
EVERYDAY, SWEET, LIE



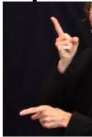
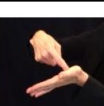
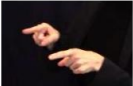
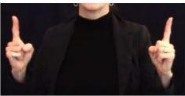
BODY GLANCE-OFF CM:12



CLOTHES, HAPPY



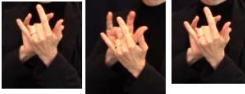
SIGNOTATION ASL WRITER'S GUIDE

FIRM CONTACT CM:13  RIGHT, ESTABLISH 	CONTACT + BOUNCE CM:14  ON-TIME, PRINT 
FIRM CONTACT + BOUNCE CM:15  ILLEGAL, TRICK/FOOL 	TAP-TAP (2) FINGERTIP FIRM CM:16  OWE \$ 
PARALLEL CM:17  PARALLEL, HIGHWAY 	APPROACHES WITHOUT CONTACT CM:18  REDUCE MEET SOMEONE, NEAR 
KISS CM:19  KISS-FIST 	SCRATCH CM:20  BEAR, ANALYZE, SUSPECT 

CONTACT
CONTINUOUS CM:21



ROMANCE, EMPHASIZE



PINCH-PULL CM:22



VOLUNTEER, HAIR



PULL APART CM:23



STORY, SENTENCE



DRAGS CM:24



HUNGRY, DEPRESSED, CRY



CONTACT,
BOUNCE,
CONTACT CM:25



PARENTS, DEAF, HEAD



WAVE+DRAGS CM:26



DRAW PICTURE, METH



HINGE CM:27



BOOK, MOTH



CROSSED ARMS CM: 28



LOVE, REST, SECURE



CRADLE ARMS CM: 29



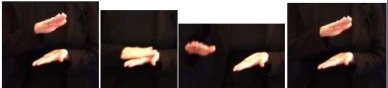
DAUGHTER/SON, BABY



CONTACT + UP-SWOOP CM: 30



COLLEGE, UNIVERSITY



TWIST + TURN FORWARD CM: 31



CRAFTS, TO MAKE



TOUCH, TURN, TOUCH CM: 32



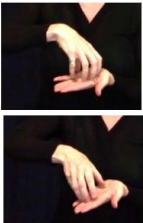
TO MAKE



TOUCH, ROTATE, TOUCH CM: 33



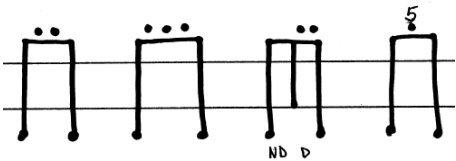
COOKIE, BUDGET



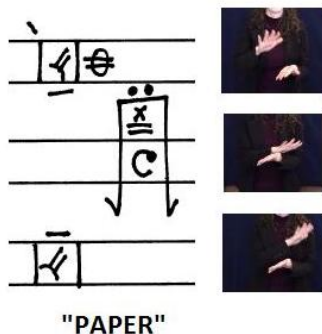
REPETITION IN MVT OR CONTACT

REPEATED MVTS

Dots above the MVT block notate the number of reps:

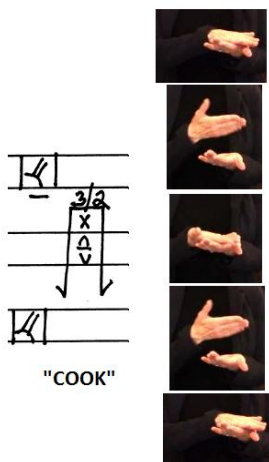


In ASL, nouns commonly have two smaller reps and verbs have one stronger rep. Many signs have only one MVT or Contact and do not need any rep dots. You can separate the ND and D HS rep sections, and also add a number for multiple-rep MVTs. The general rule is to use rep dots for 1-3 MVT reps and a single dot with the total number of reps written as a number for 4 or more reps.

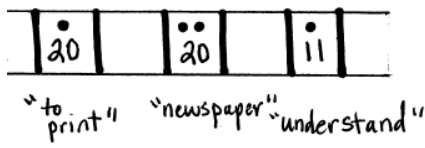


ODD NUMBER OF REPS

Some signs include contact and an odd number of reps. For example the sign "cook" can have three contacts and two movements and can be notated as a fraction:

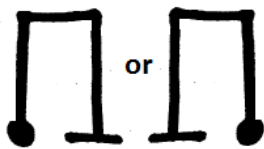


NUMBER HS REPETITIONS

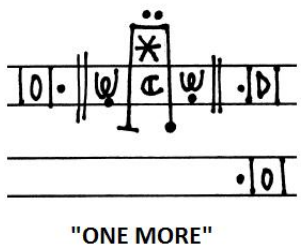
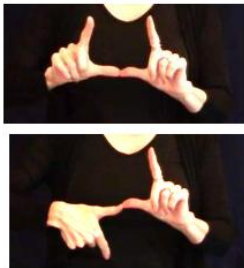
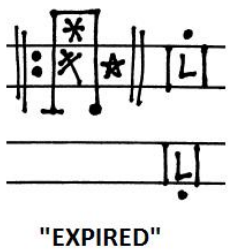


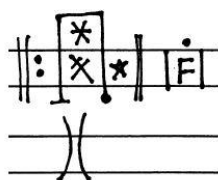
When using numbers that have a movement as a HS, identify the number of reps within the HS block.

ONE-HAND MOVEMENTS



Some signs have one moving handshape (usually the dominant HS), and one "locked" handshape. For example:



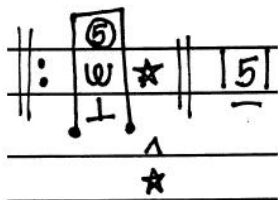


"INTERPRETER"



FINGERTIP CONTACT MOVEMENTS

To notate a specific fingertip, write the number of the finger (1 ,2, 3, 4 or 5) circled in the contact section of the movement block. Contact default is at the point of greatest extension.

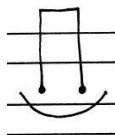


"FLIRT"



CHANGES IN MOVEMENT SIZE

Many sign meanings are modified by the size and speed of a root sign. These changes are similar to changes in tempo and time signature in music, but have semantic implications in signed languages, and can be notated.

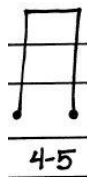
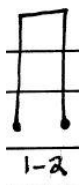


LARGE MOVEMENT



SMALL MOVEMENT

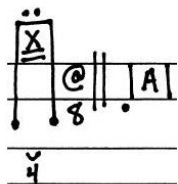
MOVEMENT SPEED



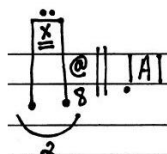
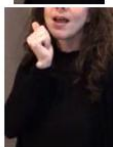
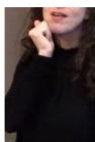
SLOW MOVEMENTS (1 OR 2) FAST MOVEMENTS (4 OR 5)

3 = AVERAGE SPEED

EXAMPLES OF MOVEMENT SIZE AND SPEED NOTATION:

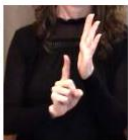
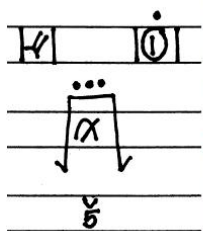


"DAILY"
"EVERYDAY"
"REGULARLY"



"DAILY"
"EVERYDAY"
"REGULARLY"





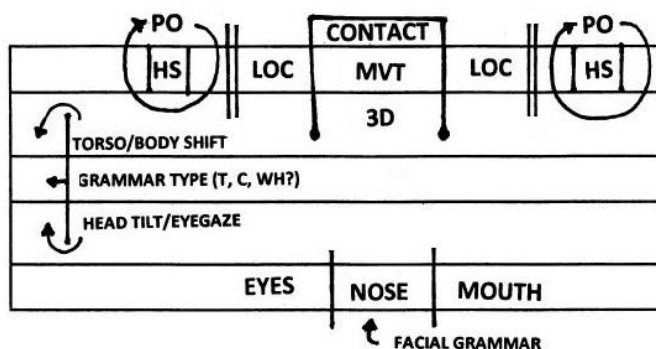
"ALARM
OR
PHONE RINGING"

PARAMETER #5

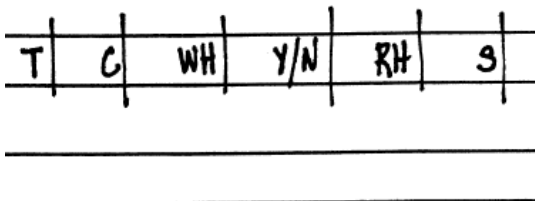
FACIAL GRAMMAR

FACIAL GRAMMAR

TYPE 1: SENTENCE TYPE



GRAMMAR BOX



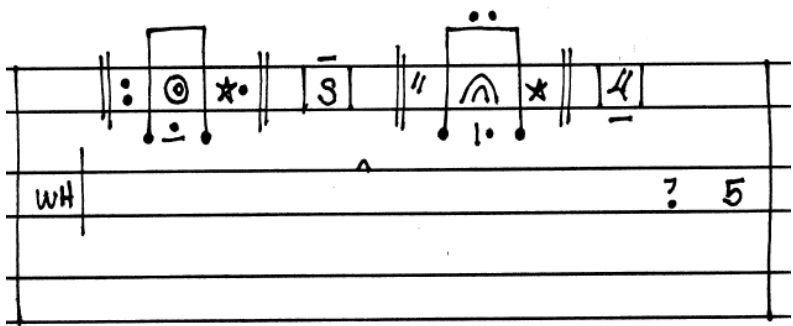
The first type of notation for facial grammar can be recorded in the GRAMMAR BOX (ie: Topic/Comment, WH?, Y/N?, RH?, Statement etc...) This enables the signer to know the prescribed facial grammar needed for the upcoming section. For example, here are some common WH ? signs:



Below is a simple WH? sentence that includes grammatically prescribed facial expression:



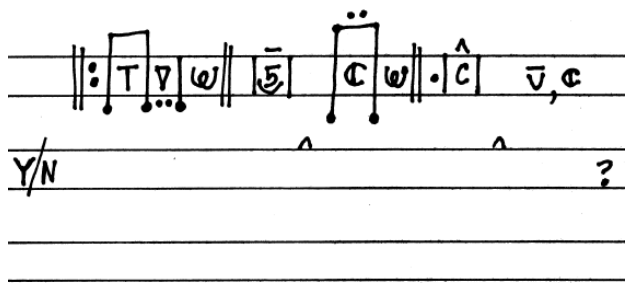
Here is that same WH question in signotation:



Below is a simple Yes/No? sentence that includes grammatically prescribed facial expression:



Here is that same Y/N question in signotation:



Below is a simple Topic/Comment sentence that includes grammatically prescribed facial expression:



Topic



Comment

T:



"My



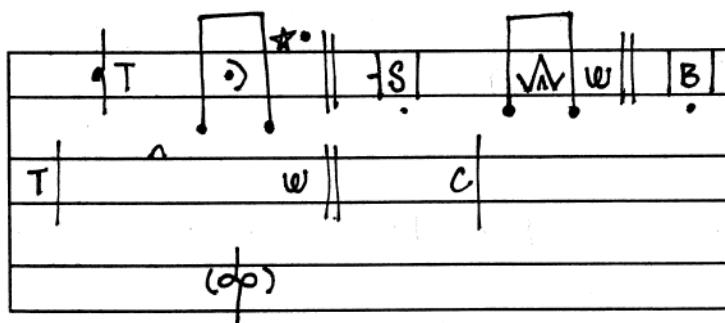
car...

C:



blue."

Here is that same Topic/Comment statement in signotation:



There are other grammatical constructions, such as conditional statements and imperatives, as well as three more important grammatical features that can be recorded in the Grammar Block: **Torso shift/Role shifting**, **Head tilt** and **Eye gaze**.

TORSO SHIFT



Position 1
torso shift (R)





Position ☆
center
"narrator"





Position 2
torso shift (L)



HEAD TILT & EYE GAZE



Upward gaze Center gaze Downward gaze





Upward gaze Position 1 Upward gaze Position 2 Downward gaze Position 1 Downward gaze Position 2

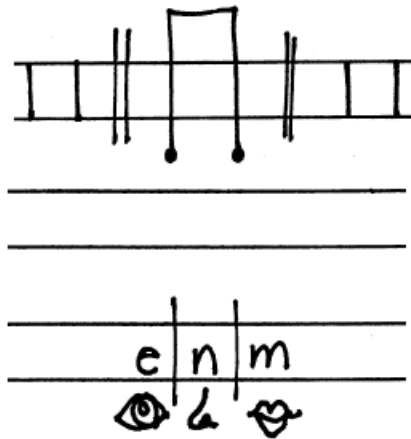


FACIAL GRAMMAR

TYPE 2: FACIAL MORPHEMES

EYES, NOSE, MOUTH

Sometimes you will need to notate specific facial grammar. These are recorded left to right: EYE, NOSE, MOUTH on the third tier of the signing staff, below the movement block:



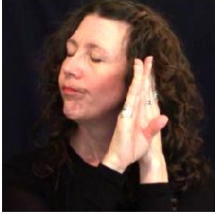
NOTE: The notations listed in this section are for illustrative purposes to show how various aspects of facial grammar can be identified, connected to a concrete sign or meaning, and recorded. The symbols themselves are arbitrary, and can be changed or replaced by the Deaf Community. Alternative facial grammar expressions can be added or removed by any community of sign language users to record the 5th parameter.

EYES



FGe = FACIAL GRAMMAR eyes

SQUINTY EYES FGe: 1 SMALL AMOUNT, TINY	FURROWED BROWS FGe: 2 ANGRY, MAD, UPSET	WIDE OPEN EYES FGe: 3 THIS, OR THAT? (COMPARISON)
EYES TRACK SIGN (SPOTLIGHT) FGe: 4 LOOK ON PAGE 36	RAPID EYE BLINKING FGe: 5 BE UNAWARE OF, SERIOUSLY? THAT'S UNUSUAL...	UPWARD GAZE FGe: 6 REMEMBERING, THINKING

DOWNWARD GAZE FGe: 7 	EYES CLOSED FGe: 8 	EYES ROLL FGe: 9 
 LOOK FOR SOMETHING, GUILTY, SUBMISSIVE	 IGNORING, NOT LISTENING	 ANNOYANCE, OH BROTHER
EYE BROWS RAISED FGe: 10 		
 Y/N QUESTIONS, PAY ATTENTION		

NOSE



FGn = FACIAL GRAMMAR nose

NOSE WRINKLE: REPEATING (X2) FGn: 1 ÷  YES, AFFIRMATIVE	NOSE WRINKLE: HELD FGn: 2 !  HUH? WHAT?
--	--

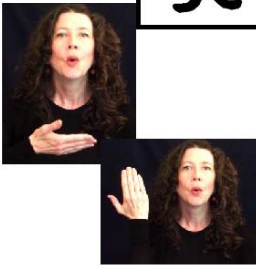
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MOUTH



FGm = FACIAL GRAMMAR mouth

OOOoo FGm: 1 OO  LONG TIME AGO, LITTLE BIT, SMALL	CHA FGm: 2 CHA  LARGE AMT, BIG	PAH! FGm: 3 PAH  FINALLY! SUCCESS!
BING FGm: 4 BING  TEND TO, TYPICALLY	ONE CHEEK PUFF FGm: 5   CYST, LUMP	PUFFED CHEEKS FGm: 6   FAT, CHUBBY

FSH FGm: 7   FINISH, DONE, STOP IT	MMM FGm: 8 mm  (DRIVING AVE SPEED) MED SIZE, AVERAGE	LOWER LIP IN AND OUT OIC FGm: 9   THAT'S INTERESTING... OH, I SEE...
KISS FGm: 10   KISS-FIST, LOVE IT! FAV	LOWER TEETH EXPOSED FGm: 11   ACCIDENTALLY RUINED, MISTAKE	TONGUE HALF-OUT FGm: 12   NOT-YET, AWKWARD, CLUMSY
BLOWING AIR FGm: 13   NOTHING, WINDY	OPEN MOUTH FGm: 14   SHOCK, OBSESS OVER	TEETH EXPOSED FGm: 15   BRUSH TEETH

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SCHA-JAH FGm: 16   SPEECH, SPEECH PRACTICE	RASPBERRY LIPS/BUZZ FGm: 17   BORED, OH BROTHER	BOW/POW FGm: 18   SHUT DOWN, BOMB BLAST
SMILE FGM: 19   BE HAPPY, SAY CHEESE	FROWN FGm: 20   BE SAD, UNHAPPY	TONGUE SWALLOW FGm: 21   ALL GONE, DISAPPEAR, GULLIBLE
SHU-ZSHA FGm: 22   MAKE FUN OF, TEASE	PTH FGm: 23   MELT AWAY, DECOMPOSE	HALF CHEEK PULL FGm: 24   RECENTLY

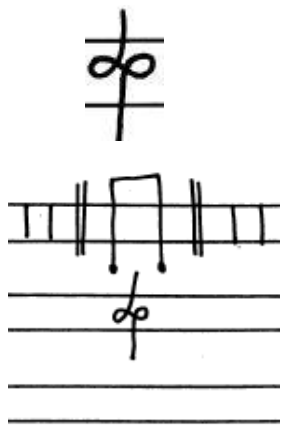
BOTH LIPS PUFFY FGm: 25 ∞  COMFORTABLE, MAKE A DECISION	JAW DROP FGm: 26 ⌋  STUNNED, SHOCKED	TONGUE SIDE TO SIDE, RAPIDLY FGm: 27 =  WANT, HAVE TO/MUST, AWESOME, COOL
COVER MOUTH FGm: 28 ⊗  NAUSEOUS, MISTAKE/OOPS		



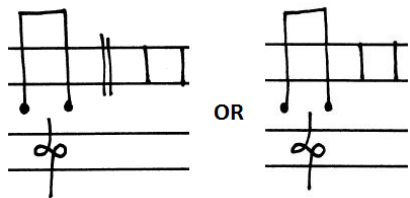
GRAMMAR NOTES

The following grammatical notes provide further guidance for accurately notating sign languages.

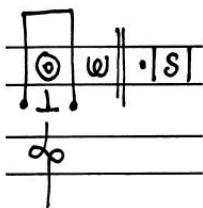
ALTERNATING MVTS



Many signs have an alternating movement pattern. The handshapes are the same, and the movements alternate from the dominant to non-dominant hand. Default location is Standard Signing Space unless otherwise notated, the number of repetitions is two (one full cycle) unless otherwise notated, and as both handshapes are the same, we can use an abbreviated format:

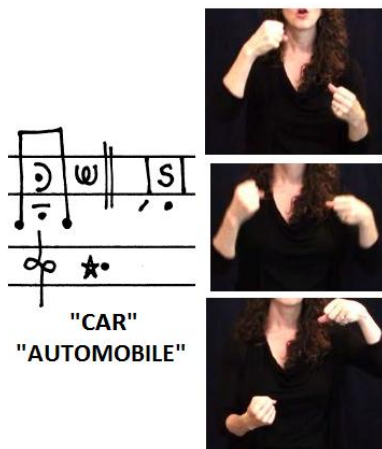


Standard Signing Space loc



"ASL"





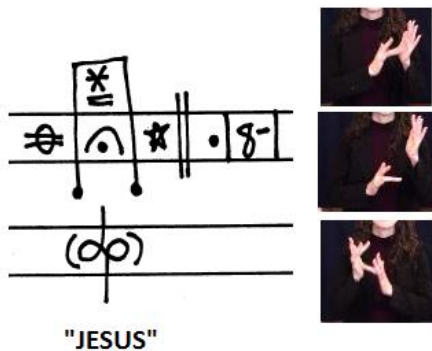
The image shows handwritten musical notation on a five-line staff. The notation consists of several notes and symbols: a quarter note with a 'C' inside a circle, a half note with a 'W' inside a circle, a double bar line, a quarter note with an 'S' inside a circle, and a quarter note with a star symbol. Below the staff, the words "CAR" and "AUTOMOBILE" are written. To the right of the notation are three vertically stacked photographs of a person with long dark hair, wearing a black top, performing the sign for 'CAR' with their hands.

"CAR"
"AUTOMOBILE"

LATERAL ALTERNATING MOVEMENTS



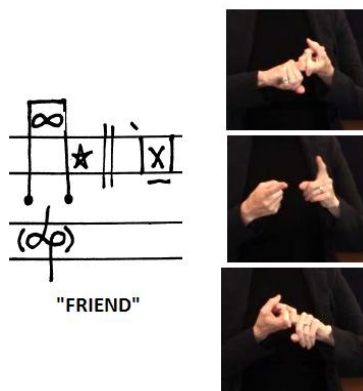
Some movements alternate laterally. An example is the sign glossed: "Jesus" which has an alternating pattern:



The image shows handwritten musical notation on a five-line staff. The notation consists of several notes and symbols: a quarter note with a star symbol inside a circle, a half note with a circle containing a dot, a quarter note with a star symbol, a double bar line, a quarter note with a dot, and a quarter note with a star symbol. Below the staff, the word "JESUS" is written. To the right of the notation are three vertically stacked photographs of a person with long dark hair, wearing a black top, performing the sign for 'JESUS' with their hands.

"JESUS"

NOTE: The palm location was added to clarify the contact location.

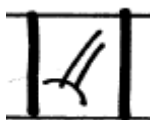


The image shows musical notation for the word "FRIEND". The notation consists of a treble clef with a whole note (infinity symbol), a quarter note (star), and a quarter note (X). Below the treble clef is a bass clef with a whole note (infinity symbol). To the right of the notation are three photographs of hands in different positions, corresponding to the notes in the notation.

"FRIEND"

BASE HANDSHAPE PAIRS (BHS-P)

Because a BHS is so common, we can create an iconic symbol for this HS. The standard BHS is an open "B" with the thumb extended out to the side, palm orientation upward to the sky and fingertips angled towards the midline, (ie: ND HS "cook"). Notated alone, the **default position** for the non-dominant BHS is palm up, fingertips angled to the midline in a relaxed position. The BHS-P location is in the **Standard Signing Space** unless otherwise notated. **Contact** is presumed **on the palm** area of a BHS unless otherwise notated.



NON DOMINANT BHS: Palm Orientation is up to the sky



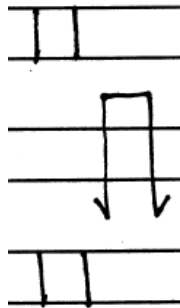
DOMINANT BHS

Palm Orientation must be clarified (up/down) for this BHS

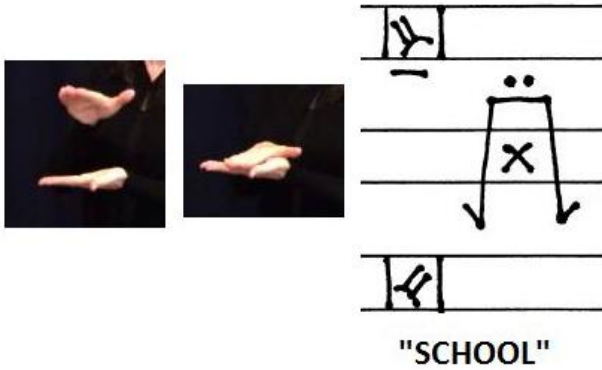
BASE HANDSHAPE PAIRS: **V**ERTICAL

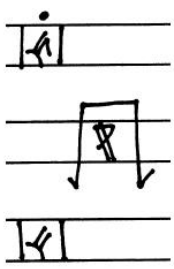
A Vertical BHS serves as a foundation or support in the up and down or vertical plane. The majority of BHS-P are vertical.

V BHS FORMAT



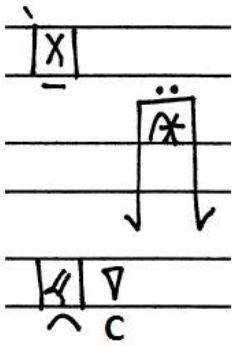
SAMPLE BASE HANDSHAPE: VERTICAL





"NEW"

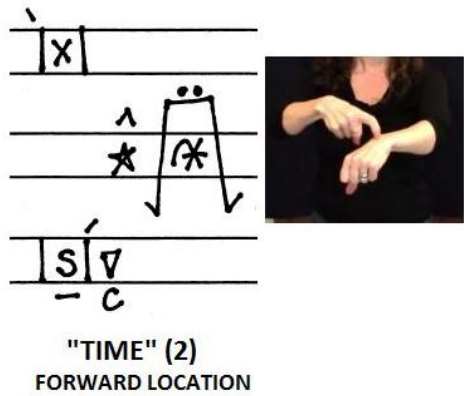




"TIME"



NOTE: The default location for the V BHS is in the Standard Signing Space. The added wrist location notated above refers to a specific location for the contact on the BHS. Also note the BHS can vary as in this relaxed BHS for “time”.

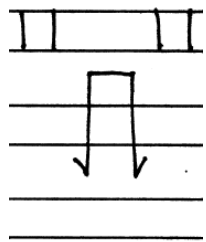


NOTE: A change in the overall location of the BHS-P can be notated to the left of the movement block, as in this sign which is articulated further forward in the signing space.

BASE HANDSHAPE PAIRS: LATERAL

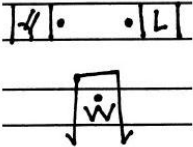
A lateral base handshape serves as a foundation or support on the side-to-side or horizontal plane.

L BHS FORMAT



SAMPLE BASE HANDSHAPE: LATERAL

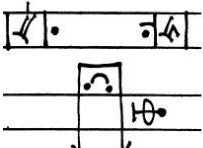




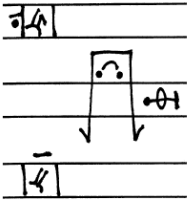
"ILLEGAL"
"PROHIBITED"
"UNLAWFUL"
"AGAINST THE RULES"

Palm Locations for BHSP

A notation to indicate whether a BHSP movement occurs from the palm to fingertip area or fingertip to palm area is notated next to the movement block:





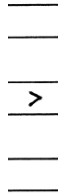




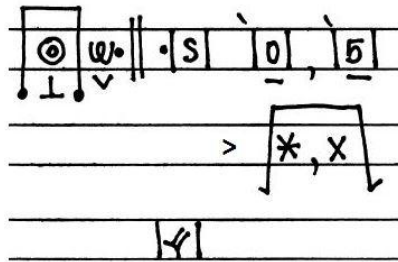
"OFTEN"

"LESSON"

COMPOUND SIGNS

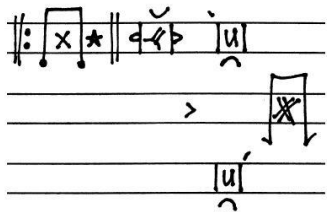


Some signs are created by joining two signs. In the example below, a one-handed sign: "SIGN" is combined with a BHS sign: "TO MAKE A NOTE" to form a new compound sign. A (>) symbol joins the two signs mid-staff:



"SIGNOTATION"

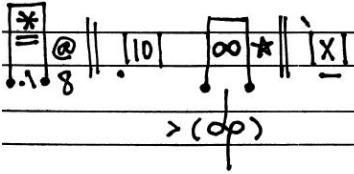
Here are a few more examples:



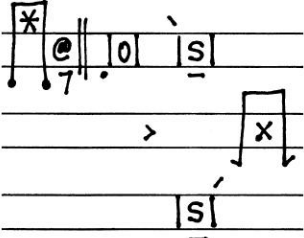
"BABYSIT"

"CHILDCARE"



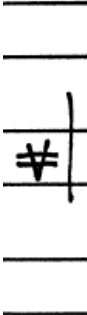


"GIRLFRIEND"



"HOMEWORK"
"ASSIGNMENT"

CONJUGATION OF VERBS



ASL has a set of verbs that are conjugated in the same way romance

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languages (French, Spanish, Italian) conjugate verbs. Directional verbs in ASL take a root verb such as "teach" and conjugate or modify in consistent patterns to indicate first person, second person and third person. For example the verb "to teach" is modified directionally to express:

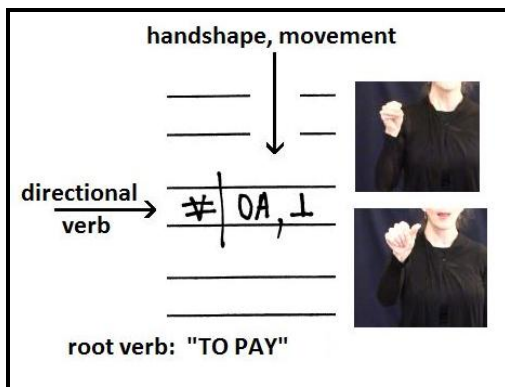
- I teach
- I teach you
- You teach me
- I teach her/him/all of you
- You teach each other
- She teaches him

Here is a very brief list of a few sample verbs that are similarly conjugated in ASL:

- Pay
- Give
- Call
- Email
- Come
- Go
- Help

Not all directional verbs utilize all of the possible conjugated forms, but the basic pattern is consistent for these directionalized verbs.

STEP 1: IDENTIFY THE ROOT VERB



STEP 2: ADD THE CONJUGATED FORM USING DIRECTIONAL NOTATIONS

directional conjugate

↓

I



0, A

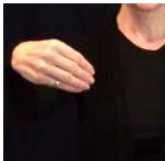


"I pay you"

directional conjugate

↓

T



0, A



"you pay me"

directional conjugate



✓

0, A



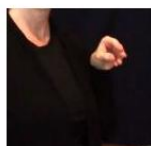
"I pay her/him" (right)

directional conjugate



✓

0, A



"I pay her/him" (left)

directional conjugate



λ

0, A



"she/he pays me" (right)

directional conjugate



↖



#0,A

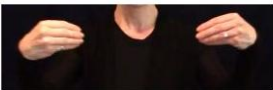


"she/he pays me" (left)

directional conjugate



↖ ↗



#0,A



"you (plural) pay me"

directional conjugate



↘ ↗



#0,A



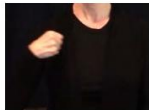
"I pay you (plural, right and left)"

S HANSEN

directional conjugate



↓



≠ 0, A



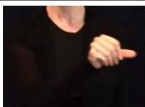
"you pay us"



directional conjugate



↓



≠ 0, A



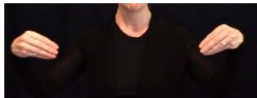
"I pay you all"



directional conjugate



↓

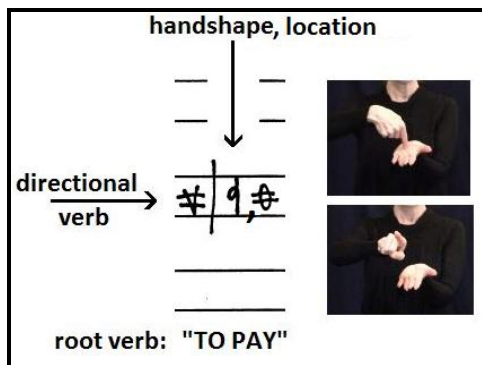


≠ 0, A

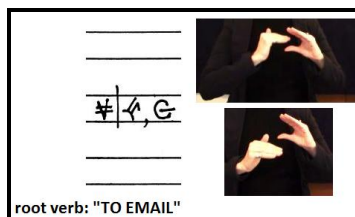
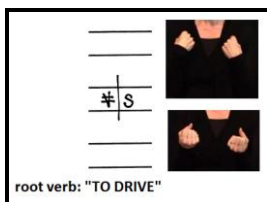
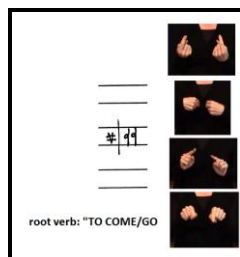
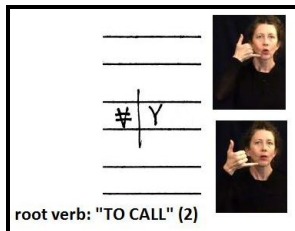
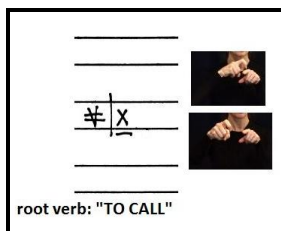


"you two pool your money"
"you share the cost"

Notice in the examples above the P.O. is omitted. Only the required detail will be added until the notation is differentiated from other directional conjugates. (ie: "TO TELL" below). Directional conjugates would need to be collected and recorded in a "Conjugated Verbs" notation chart to ensure clear standardized notation.



SAMPLE ROOT VERBS:



Hand sign for "TO EMAIL" (2). The sign is represented by a musical notation on a five-line staff: a sharp sign (#) on the second line, followed by a vertical bar, then the numbers 4 and 0 with a comma between them. To the right of the staff are three small photographs showing the hand in different positions for this sign.

root verb: "TO EMAIL" (2)

Hand sign for "TO GIVE". The sign is represented by a musical notation on a five-line staff: a sharp sign (#) on the second line, followed by a vertical bar, then the number 0 with a greater-than sign (>). To the right of the staff are two small photographs showing the hand in different positions for this sign.

root verb: "TO GIVE"

Hand sign for "TO GIVE". The sign is represented by a musical notation on a five-line staff: a sharp sign (#) on the second line, followed by a vertical bar, then the letters XX. To the right of the staff are two small photographs showing the hand in different positions for this sign.

root verb: "TO GIVE"

Hand sign for "TO GIVE" (1 hand). The sign is represented by a musical notation on a five-line staff: a sharp sign (#) on the second line, followed by a vertical bar, then the letter X. To the right of the staff are two small photographs showing the hand in different positions for this sign.

root verb: "TO GIVE" (1 hand)

Hand sign for "TO HELP". The sign is represented by a musical notation on a five-line staff: a sharp sign (#) on the second line, followed by a vertical bar, then the number 10. To the right of the staff are two small photographs showing the hand in different positions for this sign.

root verb: "TO HELP"

Hand sign for "TO SEE". The sign is represented by a musical notation on a five-line staff: a sharp sign (#) on the second line, followed by a vertical bar, then the number 2. To the right of the staff are two small photographs showing the hand in different positions for this sign.

root verb: "TO SEE"

Hand sign for "TO TEACH". The sign is represented by a musical notation on a five-line staff: a sharp sign (#) on the second line, followed by a vertical bar, then the number 0 with a dot above it. To the right of the staff are two small photographs showing the hand in different positions for this sign.

root verb: "TO TEACH"

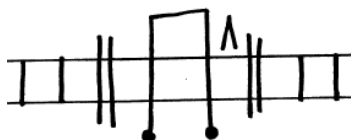
Hand sign for "TO TELL". The sign is represented by a musical notation on a five-line staff: a sharp sign (#) on the second line, followed by a vertical bar, then the numbers 4 and 3 with a comma between them. To the right of the staff are two small photographs showing the hand in different positions for this sign.

root verb: "TO TELL"

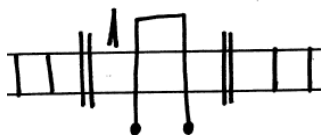
Hand sign for "TO WALK". The sign is represented by a musical notation on a five-line staff: a sharp sign (#) on the second line, followed by a vertical bar, then the letter M. To the right of the staff is one small photograph showing the hand in the position for this sign.

root verb: "TO WALK"

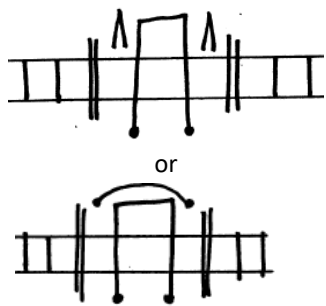
CROSS-OVER LOCATIONS



When the ND HS is on the other side of the signing space, it is notated:



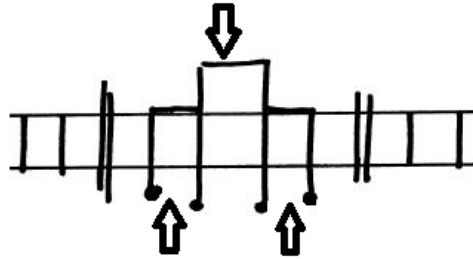
When both hands are on the opposite side of their standard signing side, you can notate it either using:



"PLEASED" (TO MEET YOU)

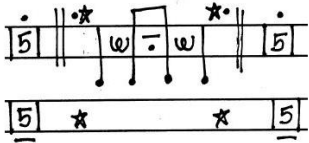
EMBEDDED MOVEMENTS

EXTERNAL PATH/PRIMARY MOVEMENT

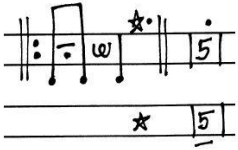


INTERNAL 2ND MOVEMENT

The internal and external movements can be notated. For example:

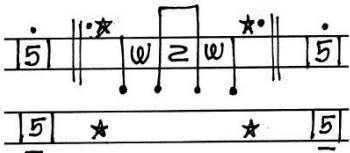


"SNOW"

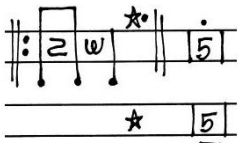


"SNOW"
(MIRROR NOTATION)





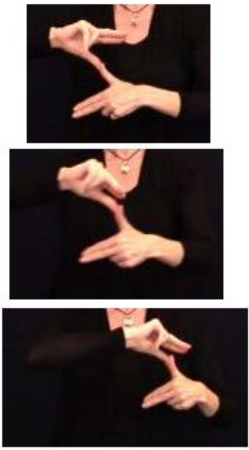
"SNOW" (CURVY)



"SNOW" (CURVY)
(MIRROR NOTATION)



"HURRICANE"



NOTE: This sign can be articulated many ways, this is just one variation. The horizontal arc pathway can be either to the right or left.

"BUTTERFLY"



FINGERSPELLING NUMBERS AND DATES

Fingerspelling, numbers, dates, and loan sign are all recorded on the second tier, mid-signing staff.

S HANSEN

_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____
Marie Jones	1957	6/28/15
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____

_____	_____
_____	_____
\$5.60	2nd
_____	_____
_____	_____

John Baker

(206) 531-7280

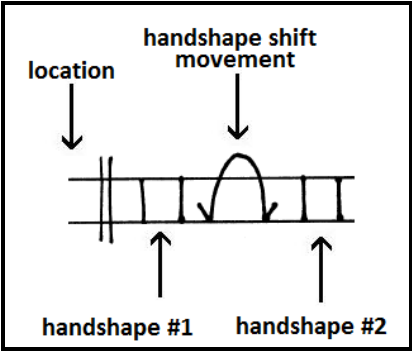
301 Poplar St.

Loan Sign examples:

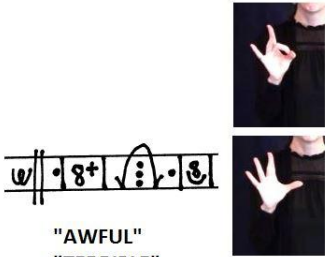
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____
#Style	#Email	#Kill
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____

HANDSHAPE SHIFT

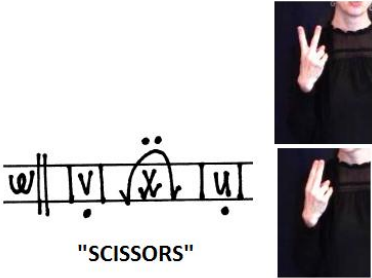
If a sign occurs in one location, and the only movement is a change in handshape, a handshape shift notation can be used:



ASL: "DO-DO"
"WHAT ARE YOU DOING?"
"TO BE BUSY"



"AWFUL"
"TERRIBLE"
"INCREDIBLE"
"UNBELIEVABLE"

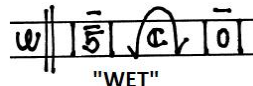


"SCISSORS"

S HANSEN


 "DOG"
 "CANINE"
 SPANISH: "PERRO"

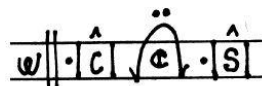



 "WET"
 "MOIST"
 "DAMP"




 "TOO BAD"
 "TOUGH LUCK"

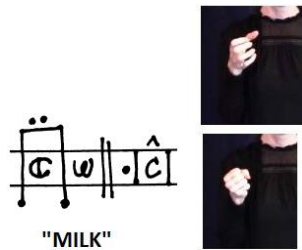



 "MILK"



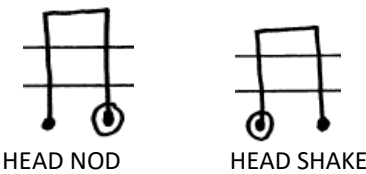
NOTE: Signs that have an "open and close" movement (M:23) can also be

written in a standard format:



HEAD NOD AND SHAKE

Shorthand notation for a head nod or shake can be notated on the MVT block, which incorporates these important grammatical components with the sign movement articulation:

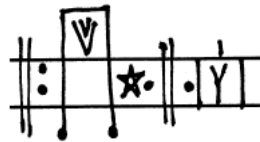


MIRROR MVTS

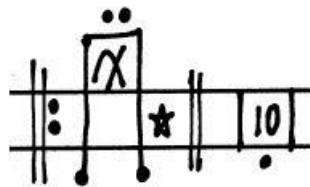
Many signs are made with identical handshapes doing the same exact movement in the same relative location along the Midline Plane simultaneously



IDENTICAL MIRROR MVTS

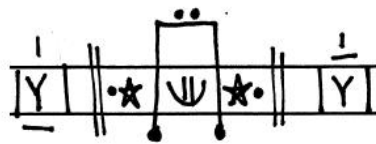


"PLAY"



"GAME"

NOTE: A different articulation of the sign play cannot be written as a mirror movement as it has different palm orientations:



"PLAY" (2)

CONVERGENT/DIVERGENT MIRROR MVTS

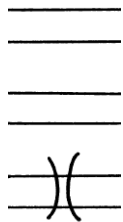


Mirror movements that converge or diverge can be notated to alert the reader to this feature. Here is a sample of a convergent mirror movement:

A musical staff with five lines. The first line has a double bar line followed by a slanted double bar line. The second line has a C-clef. The third line has a star symbol. The fourth line has a slanted double bar line. The fifth line has a double bar line. Below the staff are the words "HURT" and "PAIN".

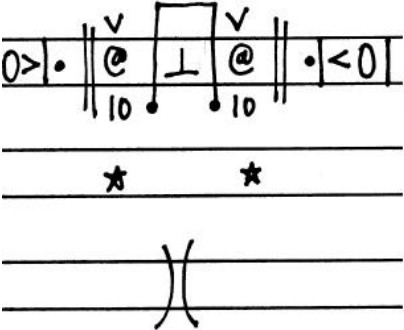
Three video frames showing a person's hands in a convergent mirror movement. The hands are positioned in front of the chest, with the fingers pointing towards each other.

PERSON-MARKER



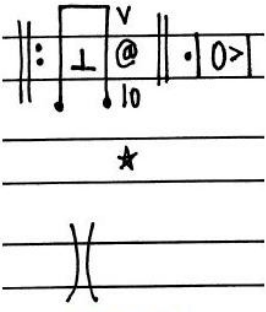
PERSON-MARKER NOTATION

Here is a sample notation of the ASL verb "teach":



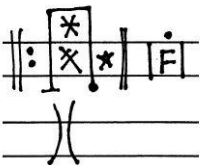
"TEACHER"





"TEACHER"
(MIRROR NOTATION)



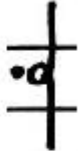
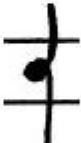
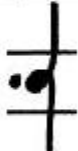


"INTERPRETER"



P PRONOUNS

Signed languages use pronouns both formal and informal, along with the reflexive (“self”) pronoun. These can be notated efficiently by including directionality to conjugate:

	INFORMAL	FORMAL
Personal pronoun (I, me, you, she, he, it, we, they)		
Possessive pronoun (my, your, her, his, its, our, their)		
Reflexive pronoun (myself, yourself, herself, himself, itself, ourselves, yourselves)		

DIRECTIONALITY OF PRONOUNS

YOU	ME	HE, SHE, IT	HE, SHE, IT	YOU ALL	WE	THEY (R)	THEY (L)
							

NOTE: Directionality is from the signer’s perspective.

SAMPLE PRONOUNS

"me" or "I"

"my"

"myself"

"me" or "I" (formal)

"you"

"your"

"yourself"

"you" (formal)

"yourself" (formal)

"our"

"their"

"her, his, its"



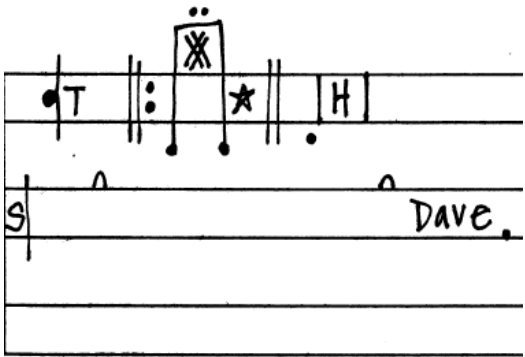


"herself, himself, itself"





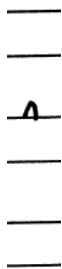
"himself, herself, itself"
(formal)



The musical notation consists of two staves. The top staff has a treble clef and contains the following notes and symbols: a quarter note with a 'T' below it, a double bar line, a quarter note with a colon ':' below it, a quarter note with a box containing an 'X' and two dots above it, a quarter note with a star '*' below it, a double bar line, and a half note with an 'H' below it. The bottom staff has a bass clef and contains the following notes and symbols: a quarter note with an 'S' below it, a half note, a double bar line, a half note, and a quarter note with 'Dave.' below it.

"MY NAME IS DAVE."

SEPARATION OF SIGNS IN A PHRASE



SEPARATION OF SIGNS

Here is a sample notation of the ASL WH ? “Your Mom, where?”
(English: “Where is your Mom?”):

The diagram illustrates the separation of signs for the ASL phrase "Your Mom, where?". It features a grid of hand signs and a musical notation staff below it.

The grid of hand signs is arranged as follows:

- Top row: One sign (index finger pointing up).
- Second row: Two signs (left hand: palm facing forward; right hand: index finger pointing up).
- Third row: One sign (index finger pointing up).
- Fourth row: One sign (index finger pointing up).

Below the grid is a musical notation staff with two staves. The top staff contains the following notation: a quarter note with a vertical line, a quarter note with a box containing a stylized 'X' and two dots above it, a quarter note with an '@' symbol, a double bar line, a quarter note with a '5', a quarter note with a 'w', a double bar line, and a quarter note with a 'd'. The bottom staff contains the following notation: a quarter note with a 'w', a quarter note with a 'w', a quarter note with a 'd', and a quarter note with a '?'. The bottom staff is labeled "WH" at the beginning and "?" at the end.

"YOUR MOM, WHERE?"

Y_{ES}, N_O

The movement symbols for “yes” and “no” can be used on the top tier of the sign staff as a shorthand notation for these common terms:



U

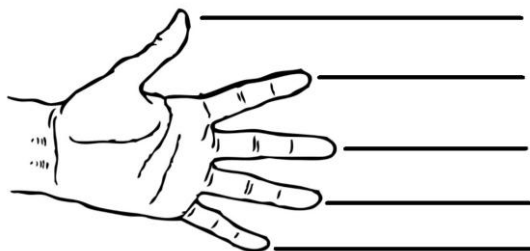
"yes"



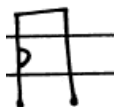
C

"no"

LISTING



"LET ME COUNT THE WAYS..."



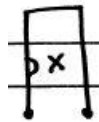
GENERIC LISTING IN THE MOVEMENT BLOCK

Typically the ND HS of an open "5" facing the signer is used as the listing template, and the D HS interacts to express the specific type of list intended. Default ND HS is a "5". A different ND base listing HS can be notated as needed. The following are examples of common forms of listing. There are many more.



ND "5" HS

1-2-3 TOUCH

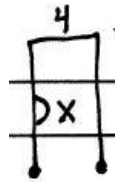
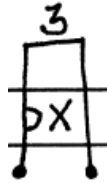


Start with the full number (ie: 2) and touch each one on fingertip using a bent index HS.

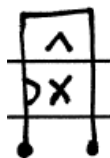


NUMBERING

To change the number of items in the generic list, notate the number over the movement block. This applies to all subsequent listing types:



1-2-3 AIR COUNT



Start with the full number (ie: 2) and “air count” each number using a bent index HS and a “bouncing” counting motion.

1



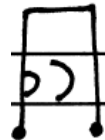
2



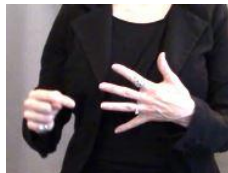
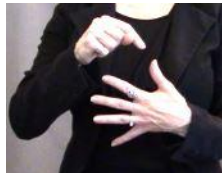
3



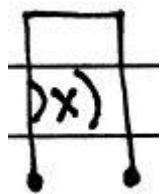
1-2-3 SWEEP



Broad general air-sweep" using a bent index HS.



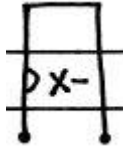
1-2-3 DRAG



Index drags down across the ND list hand.



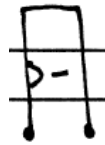
1-2-3 FLIP TOUCH



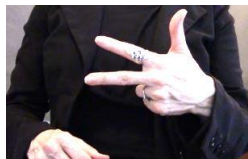
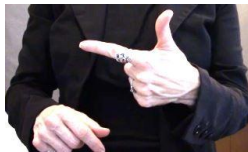
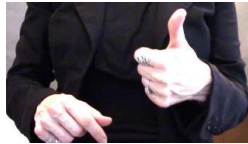
Each finger flips out one at a time and is touched on the fingertip as you count: 1,2,3,4,5



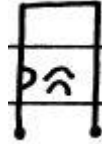
1-2-3 FLIP BOUNCE



There is no base listing HS. The listing is with one hand and has a bouncing movement between each flip.



1-2-3 CHOP TOUCH



Start with the full number (ie: 5) and touch each finger with the “bent B with thumb extended” or bent base handshape as you work thru the list in a bouncing or “chopping” motion.

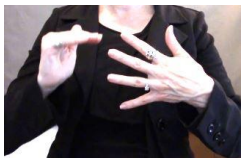


1-2-3 AIR CHOP



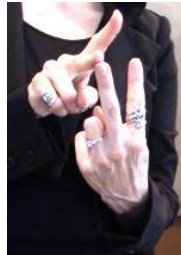
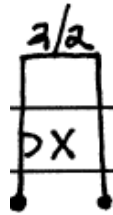
This is the same as the previous listing example, but without touching the base listing hand.

1-2-3 CHOP SWEEP

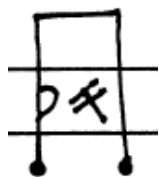


S HANSEN

EITHER



1-2-3 TWIST



1ST



2ND

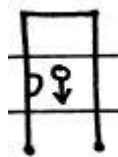


3RD

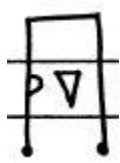


S HANSEN

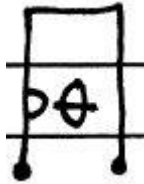
SPIRAL AIR



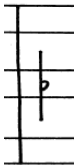
MOUSE CLICK



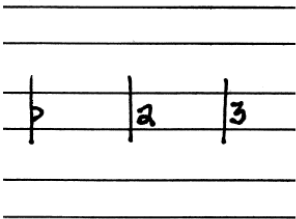
OPEN 5 DRAG



SPECIFIC LISTING



To create a list of actual items (ie: dog, cat, fish), the notation needs to shift to the grammar block on the second tier, with identification of the type of list being initiated. Then the first specific item listed is notated (for example the color “red” in a series of colors), with subsequent items numbered in the listed series:



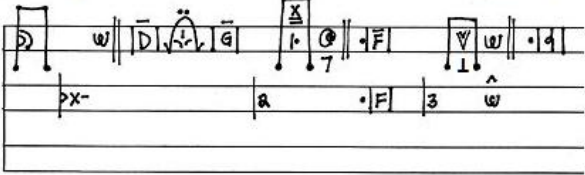
SPECIFIC LISTING

Let's look at an actual example. The signer mentions an upcoming list (generic), and then proceeds to create the list of specific named items:



generic list

specific listing



(SWEEPING LIST)

(1) "DOG"

(2) "CAT"

(3) "FISH"

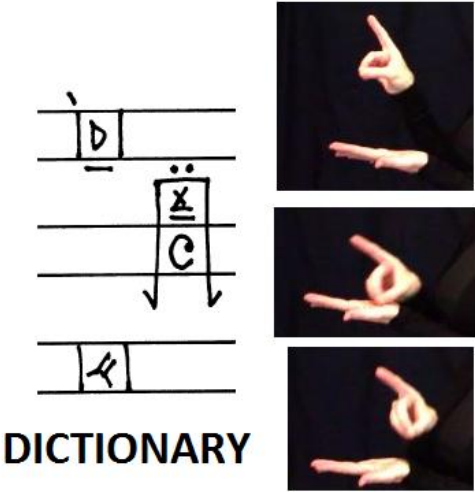
S HANSEN

Here is another example using a different listing type.

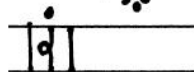
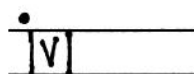
The image displays a musical score for a song by S. Hansen. The score is written on a five-line staff. Above the staff, there are eight small photographs of a woman with long dark hair, each showing a different hand gesture. The score begins with a treble clef and a key signature of one sharp (F#). The first measure contains a half note with a sharp sign above it, followed by a double bar line. The second measure contains a half note with a 'W' above it. The third measure contains a half note with a 'C' above it. The fourth measure contains a half note with a 'C' above it. The fifth measure contains a half note with a 'S' above it. The sixth measure contains a half note with a 'S' above it. The seventh measure contains a half note with a 'S' above it. The eighth measure contains a half note with a 'S' above it. The score ends with a double bar line. Below the staff, there are three labels: (1) "WATER", (2) "MILK", and (3) "COFFEE". To the left of the staff, there is a label "specific listing" with an arrow pointing to the first measure. The notation includes various symbols such as 'X', '2', '3', and 'S'.

NOTE: The first specific listing notation is count "1" and the numbering begins 2, 3, 4, 5, etc... The total anticipated number of items can be notated above the initial notation as in the example above that had a list of three types of beverages.

SIGN-TO-TEXT DICTIONARY

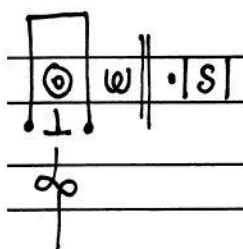


Imagine school children having independent access to a sign-to-text bilingual dictionary resource. The signs listed below are in English alphabetical order. Future signotation dictionaries would be organized according to the 5 Parameters within sections (Base Handshape Pairs, Alternating Handshapes, Mirror Movements, Handshape Shift, Compound Signs, etc...) enabling users to search for a sign and find equivalent second language terms for academic enrichment. Benefits include the ability to start with a given sign, locate the desired term and check for spelling as well as synonyms, antonyms and trilingual terms.

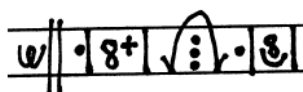


"APPLY"

"APPLICATION"



"ASL"

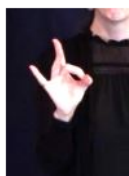


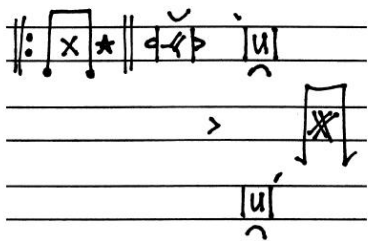
"AWFUL"

"TERRIBLE"

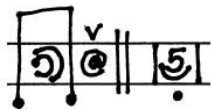
"INCREDIBLE"

"UNBELIEVABLE"

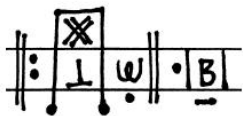




"BABYSIT"
"CHILDCARE"

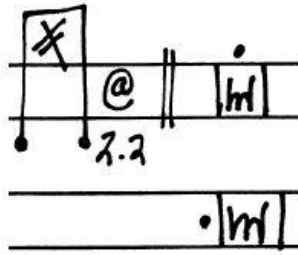


"BEAUTIFUL"
"LOVELY"
"PRETTY"
"GORGEOUS"

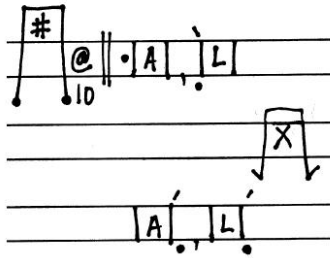


"BLOCK"
"PREVENT"
"BARRIER"
"OBSTACLE"
"THWART"

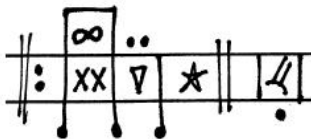




"BORING"

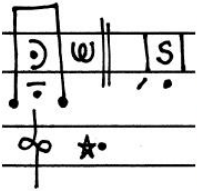


"BROTHER"

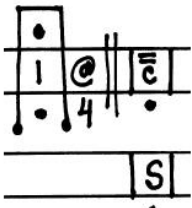


"BUTTERFLY"

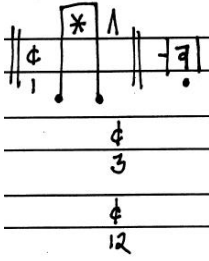




"CAR"
"AUTOMOBILE"

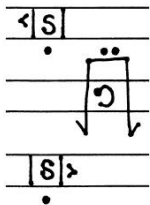


"CHERISH"
"ADORE"
"VALUE"

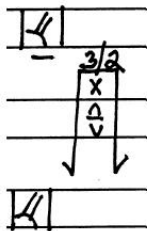


"CHINA"





"COFFEE"



"COOK"



Handwritten sign notation for "COOKIE" on a three-line staff. The first line contains a box with a 'C' and a horizontal line above it. The second line contains a box with a 'C' and a dot above it, with a vertical line and a checkmark on the left. The third line contains a box with a 'K' and a horizontal line above it.

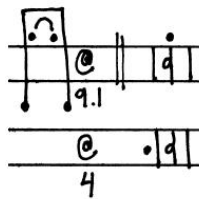
"COOKIE"

Handwritten sign notation for "CUTE", "DARLING", and "ADORABLE" on a three-line staff. The first line contains a box with an 'X' and a horizontal line above it. The second line contains a box with a 'V' and a horizontal line above it, followed by a box with a 'C' and a horizontal line above it, and then a box with 'N-' and a horizontal line above it. The third line contains a box with a '4' and a horizontal line above it.

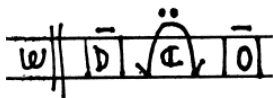
"CUTE"
"DARLING"
"ADORABLE"

Handwritten sign notation for "DAUGHTER" on a three-line staff. The first line contains a box with an 'X' and a horizontal line above it, followed by a box with a 'D' and a horizontal line above it, and then a box with 'B' and a horizontal line above it. The second line contains a box with a '4' and a horizontal line above it. The third line contains a box with a 'D' and a horizontal line above it.

"DAUGHTER"



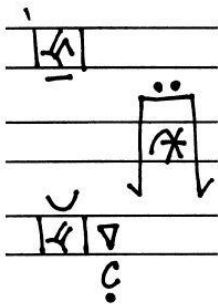
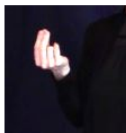
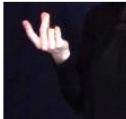
"DEAF"



ASL: "DO-DO"

"WHAT ARE YOU DOING?"

"TO BE BUSY"



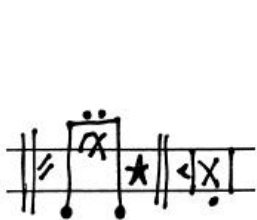
"DOCTOR"

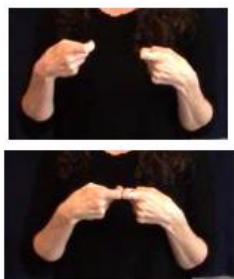
"PHYSICIAN"

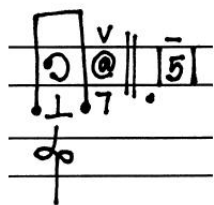



"DOG"
"CANINE"
SPANISH: "PERRO"




"ELECTRIC"
"ELECTRICITY"
"BATTERY"

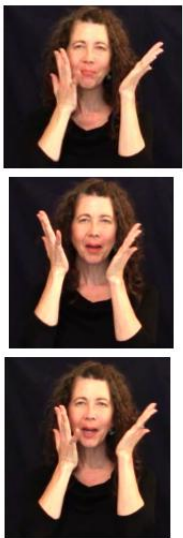


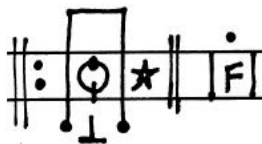


"EMBARRASSED"

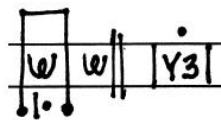
Related terms:

"MORTIFIED"
"CHAGRINED"
"HUMILIATED"

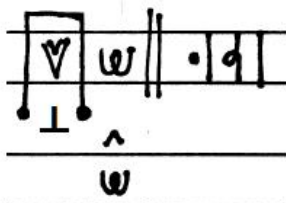




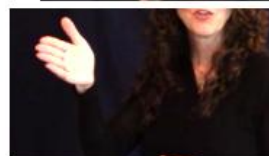
"FAMILY"



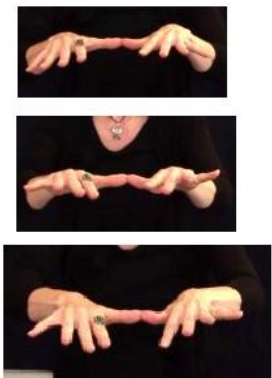
"FINGERSPELL"
"FINGERSPELLING"



"FISH"



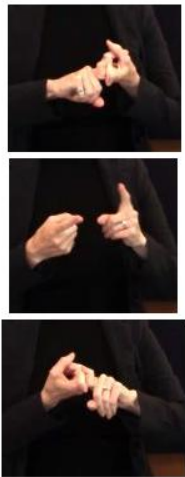
Handwritten musical notation for "FLIRT". The notation consists of a treble clef, a key signature of one sharp (F#), and a 4/4 time signature. The melody is written on a five-line staff. The first measure contains a quarter note with a circled "5" above it. The second measure contains a quarter note with a "W" above it. The third measure contains a quarter note with a star above it. The fourth measure contains a quarter note with a "5" above it. Below the staff, there is a star symbol and the word "FLIRT" in quotes.

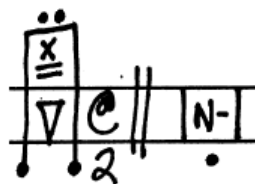


Handwritten musical notation for "FLOWER" and "POSY". The notation consists of a treble clef, a key signature of one sharp (F#), and a 4/4 time signature. The melody is written on a five-line staff. The first measure contains a quarter note with a squiggle above it. The second measure contains a quarter note with an "@" symbol above it. The third measure contains a quarter note with a "2.1" below it. The fourth measure contains a quarter note with a "2.2" below it. Below the staff, there is an "@" symbol and the words "FLOWER" and "POSY" in quotes.

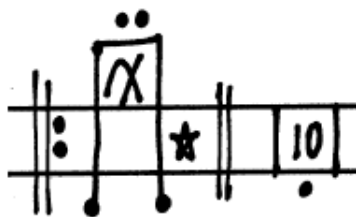


Handwritten musical notation for "FRIEND". The notation consists of a treble clef, a key signature of one sharp (F#), and a 4/4 time signature. The melody is written on a five-line staff. The first measure contains a quarter note with an infinity symbol above it. The second measure contains a quarter note with a star above it. The third measure contains a quarter note with an "X" above it. The fourth measure contains a quarter note with an "X" above it. Below the staff, there is a circled "X" symbol and the word "FRIEND" in quotes.

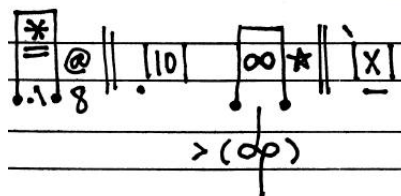




"FUNNY"
"AMUSING"



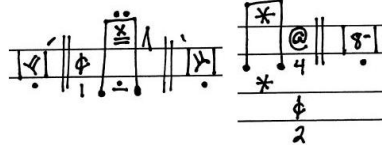
"GAME"



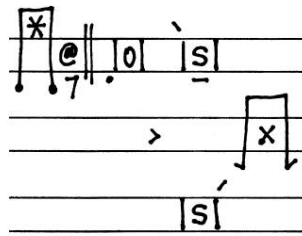
"GIRLFRIEND"



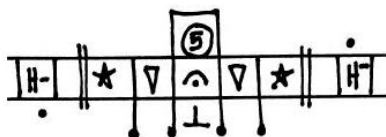
SIGNOTATION ASL WRITER'S GUIDE



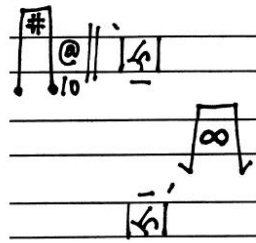
"HAPPY BIRTHDAY"



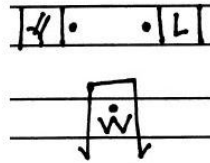
"HOMEWORK"
"ASSIGNMENT"



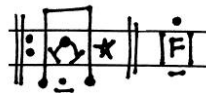
"HURRICANE"



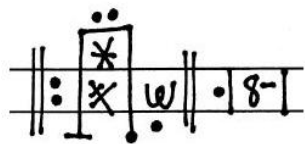
"HUSBAND"



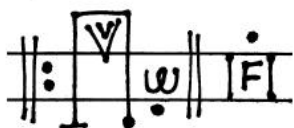
"ILLEGAL"
"PROHIBITED"
"UNLAWFUL"
"AGAINST THE RULES"



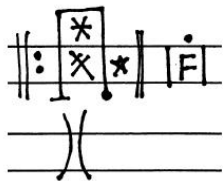
"IMPORTANT"
"CRITICAL"
"VITAL"



"ONLINE"
"INTERNET"

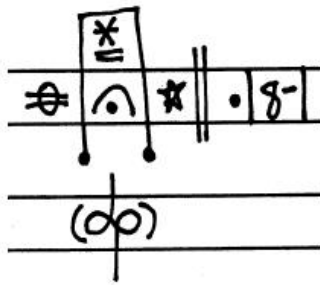


"INTERPRET"

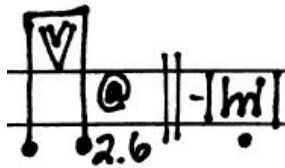


"INTERPRETER"

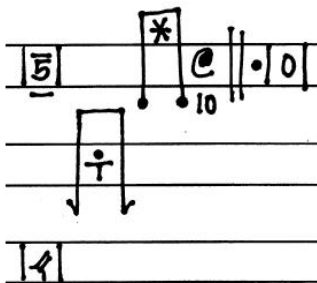




"JESUS"

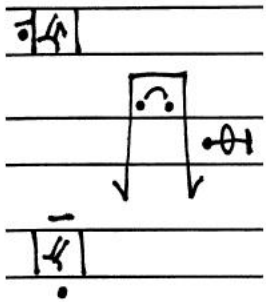


"KID"

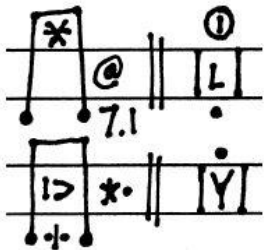


"LEARN"

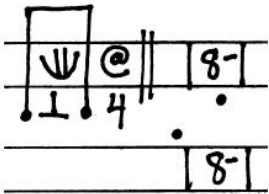




"LESSON"



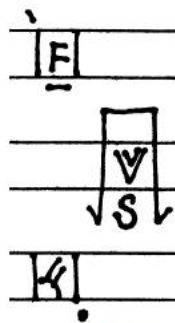
"LOOK LIKE"
"RESEMBLE"
"SIMILAR"



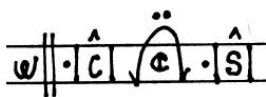
"LUCKY" / "LUCK"
"FORTUNATE"
"FORTUITOUS"



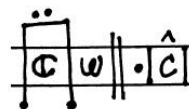
"MAKE"
"MANUFACTURE"
"PRODUCE"
"CREATE"



"MEAT"
"CONTENT" (SUBJECT)

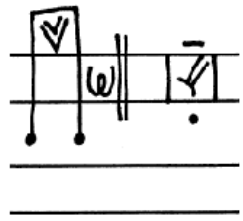


"MILK"

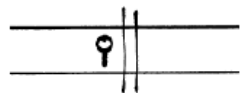


"MILK"

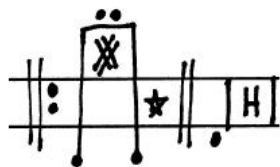




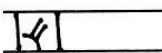
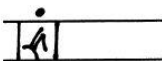




"MIRROR"

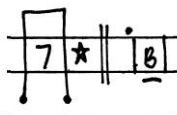


"NAME"

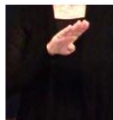


"NEW"





"NEVER"



C



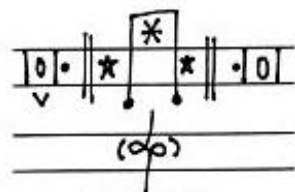
—

—

—

—

"no"



"NUMBER"

The sign notation for "OFTEN" consists of two staves. The top staff has a box containing a stylized 'f' with a dot above it, followed by a box containing a stylized 't' with a dot above it. The bottom staff has a box containing a stylized 'o' with a dot above it, followed by a box containing a stylized 'f' with a dot above it.

Two photographs showing a person's hands performing the sign for "OFTEN". The hands are positioned in front of the chest, with the fingers spread and the palms facing each other.

"OFTEN"

The sign notation for "ON THE FENCE" consists of three staves. The top staff has a box containing a stylized 'f' with a dot above it. The middle staff has a box containing a stylized 't' with a dot above it. The bottom staff has a box containing a stylized 'o' with a dot above it.

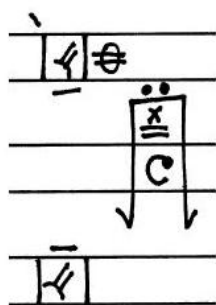
Three photographs showing a person's hands performing the sign for "ON THE FENCE". The hands are positioned in front of the chest, with the fingers spread and the palms facing each other.

"ON THE FENCE"
"UNCERTAIN"
"INDECISIVE"
"AMBIVALENT"
"EQUIVOCATE"

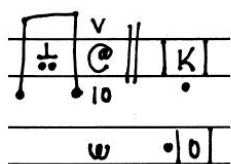
The sign notation for "ONE MORE" consists of two staves. The top staff has a box containing a stylized 'o' with a dot above it, followed by a box containing a stylized 'n' with a dot above it, followed by a box containing a stylized 'e' with a dot above it, followed by a box containing a stylized 'm' with a dot above it. The bottom staff has a box containing a stylized 'o' with a dot above it, followed by a box containing a stylized 'n' with a dot above it.

Two photographs showing a person's hands performing the sign for "ONE MORE". The hands are positioned in front of the chest, with the fingers spread and the palms facing each other.

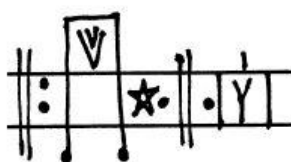
"ONE MORE"



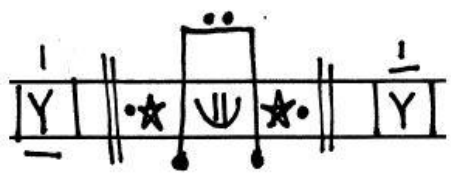
"PAPER"



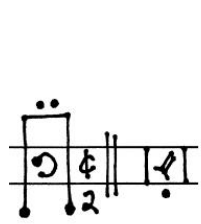
"PASS OUT"
(EITHER IN SLEEP OR BLACK OUT)
"UNCONSCIOUS"



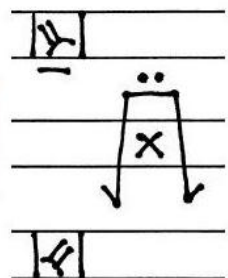
"PLAY"



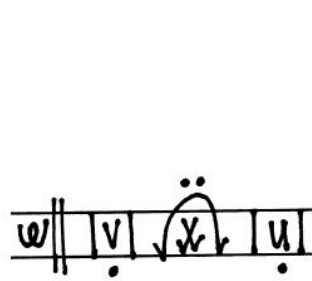
"PLAY" (2)



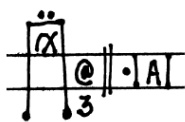
"PLEASE"



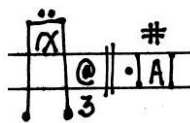
"SCHOOL"
"ACADEMIC"



"SCISSORS"



"SECRET"
"PRIVATE"
"PASS" (WORD)
"CLANDESTINE"
"CONFIDENTIAL"

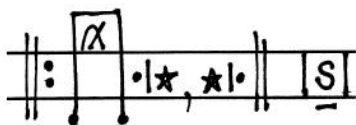


"SECRET"
"PRIVATE"
"PASS" (WORD)
"CLANDESTINE"
"CONFIDENTIAL"

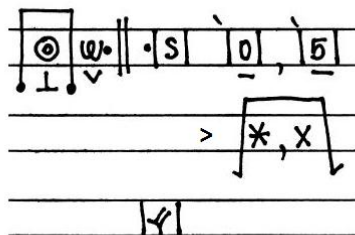


OR

(THUMBNAIL LOCATION)



"SHOE"



"SIGNOTATION"

Musical notation for "SISTER":

Staff 1: Treble clef, key signature of one sharp (F#), time signature of 8/8. The notation includes a double bar line, a whole note with a box containing 'A', and a half note with a box containing 'L'.

Staff 2: Treble clef, key signature of one sharp (F#), time signature of 8/8. The notation includes a whole note with a box containing 'A' and a half note with a box containing 'L'.

Staff 3: Treble clef, key signature of one sharp (F#), time signature of 8/8. The notation includes a whole note with a box containing 'X'.

"SISTER"



Musical notation for "SON":

Staff 1: Treble clef, key signature of one sharp (F#), time signature of 10/10. The notation includes a double bar line, a whole note with a box containing 'B', and a half note with a box containing 'A'.

Staff 2: Treble clef, key signature of one sharp (F#), time signature of 10/10. The notation includes a whole note with a box containing 'A'.

Staff 3: Treble clef, key signature of one sharp (F#), time signature of 10/10. The notation includes a whole note with a box containing 'A'.

"SON"



Musical notation for "THANK YOU":

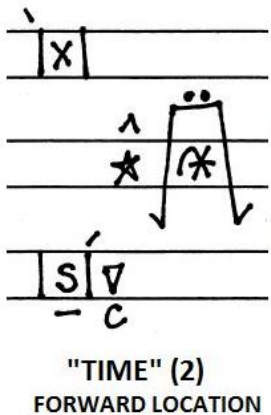
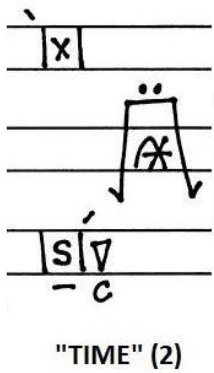
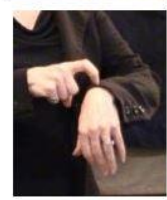
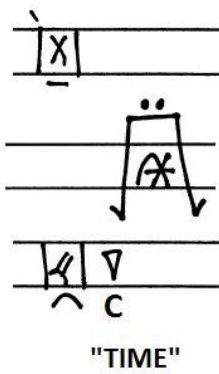
Staff 1: Treble clef, key signature of one sharp (F#), time signature of 4/4. The notation includes a double bar line, a whole note with a box containing 'L', and a half note with a box containing 'Y'.

Staff 2: Treble clef, key signature of one sharp (F#), time signature of 4/4. The notation includes a whole note with a box containing 'Y'.

Staff 3: Treble clef, key signature of one sharp (F#), time signature of 4/4. The notation includes a whole note with a box containing 'Y'.

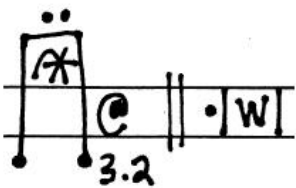
"THANK YOU"



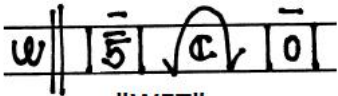




"TOO BAD"
"TOUGH LUCK"

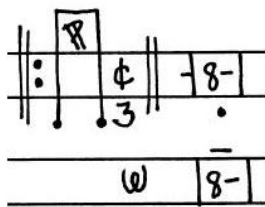


"WATER"

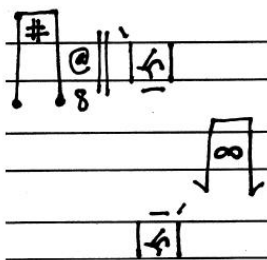


"WET"
"MOIST"
"DAMP"

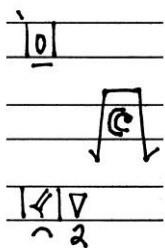




"WHAT'S UP"



"WIFE"



"X-RAY: WRIST"



"X-RAY: CHEST"





U

"yes"



WHAT ABOUT CLASSIFIERS/DEPICTING VERBS?

Classifiers, recently re-named “depicting verbs” are an important and integral part of ASL and will be the subject of a separate book dedicated to exploring this unique linguistic feature of signed languages.

ARTWORK

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